LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Complete guide, Class 6 to Career: Contents

ABOUT THIS GUIDE

This file combines the LessonPlan Career Roadmap guides for every stream and field. Information is compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year. Each guide ends with a one-page summary.

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LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Foundation Years (Class 6 to 10): Olympiads, Scholarships and the Class 10 Decision

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Class 6	Age 11-12	Start Olympiads and reading habits; Sainik School entry (AISSEE) is possible	Early exam practice, school-level routes
Class 7	Age 12-13	Try Maths and Science olympiads; explore hobbies and sports	Skill building across subjects
Class 8	Age 13-14	NMMS scholarship test; IOQM (Maths Olympiad) open from Class 8; RIMC entry†	Scholarship (Class 9-12) and olympiad ladder
Class 9	Age 14-15	Junior Science Olympiad (NSEJS) possible; Sainik School entry at Class 9; choose Maths level (CBSE)	Olympiads, NTSE preparation
Class 10	Age 15-16	Board exams; NTSE; the big decision: stream and pathway	Stream choice, polytechnic / ITI / Agniveer options
After Class 10	Age 16+	Class 11-12 (PUC in Karnataka), diploma, ITI, Agniveer, or other routes	Pathway documents for each umbrella

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-8: Explore and build

- Build reading, writing, Maths and Science basics. Try Olympiads for exposure, not pressure; sports, arts, quizzes and debates are equally valuable.
- Class 8 is the first key checkpoint: NMMS scholarship test (for government, aided and local body schools) and IOQM (Maths Olympiad) become available.

Class 9-10: Prepare and decide

- Maths level: in CBSE, Class 10 has Standard and Basic Maths. Basic Maths students were allowed to take Mathematics in Class 11 under relaxations for 2023-24 and 2025-26, subject to the school confirming aptitude, but the relaxation is tied to the old scheme and may end when the new scheme of studies is implemented. Choose Standard if Maths may matter. Karnataka SSLC rules were not found.†
- Class 10 is the exit point from school-level exams: stream choice (Science, Commerce, Arts), or diploma, ITI, Agniveer or other routes.
- Karnataka: after SSLC, Class 11-12 is the Pre-University Course (PUC). Common combinations: Science (PCMB, PCMC) and Commerce (HEBA, SEBA, CEBA and similar); the exact codes vary by college. Admissions usually open after SSLC results (May) with classes from June.†

Choosing after Class 10

- Science PCB: medicine, health, agriculture, life sciences (see Science PCB document).
- Science PCM: engineering, architecture, defence technical, research (see Science PCM document).
- Commerce: CA, CS, CMA, management, economics, law (see Commerce document).
- Arts and Humanities: civil services, law, psychology, media, design, teaching (see Arts and Humanities document).

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- Direct routes after Class 10: Polytechnic and ITI, Agniveer (Defence), skill courses (see Polytechnic and ITI, Defence, and Skills and Entrepreneurship documents).

3. Olympiads, scholarships and school-level exams (Class 6-10)

Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
SOF olympiads: NSO / ISO (Science), IMO (Maths), IEO (English), IGKO (GK)	Science Olympiad Foundation (SOF)	1-12	Level 1 at school, Level 2 for top performers. Some sources say NSO was renamed ISO†	2026-27: IMO 23 Oct, 26 Nov, 10 Dec; IEO 30 Sep, 27 Oct, 17 Nov; IGKO 22 Sep, 6 Oct, 3 Nov; NSO/ISO Level 1 30 Oct, 19 Nov, 3 Dec; Level 2 Feb 2027; school registration by 31 Aug†
IOQM (Maths) -> RMO -> INMO	HBCSE with MTAI	8-12 (born 1 Aug 2007 to 31 Jul 2014)	Three stages, then IMO selection camp	IOQM held 6 Sep 2026; RMO likely 15 Nov 2026; INMO likely 17 Jan 2027†
NSEJS -> INJSO (Junior Science)	IAPT (not HBCSE); jso.indapt.org.in	9-10 (age window conflicts)†	NSEJS: 60 Q, 2 hr, Physics, Chemistry, Biology; then INJSO	NSEJS 22 Nov 2026 (registration 21 Aug - 14 Sep, fee 300); INJSO about first week Feb 2027†
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8 (govt, aided and local body schools)	Single written test; 12,000 per year in Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb (last held 1 Feb 2026)
NTSE	NCERT; Karnataka Stage 1 via DSERT	10	Stage 1 state, Stage 2 national; scholarship amounts not confirmed	Notification awaited; Stage 1 expected around Nov-Dec 2026†
INSPIRE-MANAK	DST with NIF	6-12	School nominates up to 5 ideas; 10,000 award	Last nominations closed 15 Sep 2025; check inspireawards-dst.gov.in
AISSEE (Sainik School entrance)	NTA	6 and 9	Offline OMR; boys and girls; 2026 exam 18 Jan	Registration usually Oct-Nov†
NSE senior olympiads (NSEP, NSEC, NSEA, NSEB)	IAPT then HBCSE	10-12 / 11-12	See Science documents	NSEA 21 Nov, NSEP / NSEC / NSEB 22 Nov 2026

Tip for parents: Olympiads do not decide admission but sharpen concepts. Choose one or two that fit your child; keep sports, arts, reading and rest in balance.

4. Key decisions and checkpoints

Class 10 Maths decision (CBSE)	
Standard Maths	Keeps every stream open (PCM, Economics Hons, Actuarial, Statistics, Architecture)
Basic Maths	Meant for students who do not plan to study Maths further; Maths in Class 11 was allowed in 2023-24 and 2025-26 with school approval; future rule may change†
Karnataka SSLC	No separate Basic / Standard Maths found at the time of compilation†

Class 10 to Class 11 in Karnataka (PUC)	
Board	Department of Pre-University Education (DPUE); colleges apply their own cutoffs
Science combinations	PCMB, PCMC; Biology or Computer Science as the fourth subject
Commerce combinations	HEBA, SEBA, CEBA and similar (codes vary)†
Timing	Applications after SSLC results (about May); classes from June†
Documents	SSLC marksheet, transfer certificate, photos, caste certificate if applicable

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Sainik School and school-level defence entry	
Details	See the Defence document for AISSEE rules (Class 6 age 10-12; Class 9 age 13-15), reservation and timing†

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
School-level skills (coding, robotics, debate, MUN, chess, sports)	All students	Builds profile for any later stream
Tuition and learning support	All students	Choose reputable programmes; quality varies
Counselling after Class 10 (interest and aptitude tests)	Class 9-10	Use LessonPlan and school counsellors to compare options

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
NTSE scholarship	NCERT	Successful Stage 2 candidates	Amounts not confirmed at the time of compilation	Notification awaited†
INSPIRE-MANAK award	DST with NIF	Nominated ideas, Class 6-12	10,000 one-time	School nomination cycle
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†

Note: scholarship amounts and income limits change; always confirm on the official portal before applying.†

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
Class 11-12 (PUC / CBSE / ICSE)	2 yr	Class 10 pass	Stream choice drives the pathway
Polytechnic diploma	3 yr	SSLC; DTE counselling	See Polytechnic and ITI document
ITI trades	6 mo - 2 yr	Class 8 or 10 by trade	See Polytechnic and ITI document
Agniveer	4 yr service	Age 17.5-21; Class 10 / 12 by post	See Defence document
Skill courses	Weeks to months	Open enrolment	See Skills and Entrepreneurship document

Examples: Karnataka PUC colleges (government and private), CBSE / ICSE schools, Sainik Schools, government polytechnics and ITIs.†

7. Career outcomes

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Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Not a career stage yet	Class 6-10 is exploration: build skills, discover interests, keep academics strong	Choose a pathway after Class 10 using the umbrella documents

8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Science PCB, Science PCM, Commerce, Arts and Humanities: stream documents for after Class 10.
- Law, Design and Architecture, Health and Allied, Agriculture, Defence, Hospitality-Aviation-Maritime, Sports and Arts: umbrella documents.
- Polytechnic and ITI, Skills and Entrepreneurship: direct routes after Class 8 or 10.

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ONE-PAGE GIST: Foundation (Class 6-10)

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-7	Reading, Maths, Science basics; try Olympiads, sports, arts; AISSEE (Sainik School) at Class 6
Class 8	NMMS scholarship test; IOQM (Maths Olympiad) opens; RIMC†
Class 9	NSEJS (Junior Science); Maths level decision (CBSE); Sainik School at Class 9
Class 10	Boards; NTSE; decide stream or direct route
After Class 10	PUC (PCMB / PCMC / Commerce / Arts), diploma, ITI, Agniveer
Next step	Open the Science, Commerce, Arts or umbrella document for your goal

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
SOF olympiads (NSO/ISO, IMO, IEO)	Sep-Dec; Level 2 Feb	School-based Level 1 then Level 2	Check SOF
IOQM / RMO / INMO	Sep / Nov / Jan	Class 8-12 Maths ladder	Check HBCSE
NSEJS / INJSO	Nov / Feb	Class 9-10 Junior Science; 60 Q, 2 hr	Check IAPT
NMMS	Jan-Feb (Class 8)	Scholarship test; 12,000 per year	Check DSERT
NTSE	Stage 1 Nov-Dec†	Class 10 national talent scholarship	Check NCERT
AISSEE	Jan (Class 6 / 9)	Sainik School entrance; offline OMR	Check NTA

Key rules: keep Standard Maths if Maths may matter; PUC admissions follow SSLC results; Olympiads sharpen but do not decide admission.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8), NTSE, INSPIRE-MANAK.†

Careers: not yet; use this stage to explore and then pick the pathway document.

Want a personalised roadmap or counselling? Contact LessonPlan, Yelahanka, Bangalore.

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LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Science - PCB (Physics, Chemistry, Biology): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Start Olympiads; build Science and Maths basics	Olympiad ladder, NMMS scholarship (Class 8)
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Maths level (CBSE Basic vs Standard); Junior Science Olympiad	Keeps PCMB open if Standard Maths is taken
Stream choice	After Class 10	Choose PCB (+ optional Maths / Computer Science / Psychology) in Class 11-12 (PUC in Karnataka)	Eligibility for NEET, CUET, IISER, life-science degrees
Preparation	Class 11-12	Boards + entrance exam focus (NEET / KCET / CUET / IAT)	Merit seats, scholarships (INSPIRE-SHE, CSSS)
Degree	After Class 12	Medical, allied health, pharmacy, life sciences, agriculture, research	Professional licence or research career
Postgraduate	3-6 years later	Specialise (MD/MS, MSc, M.Pharm, PhD)	Specialist and research roles
Career	-	Clinical, research, industry, public health, teaching	See section 7

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-8: Foundation

- Decision: join Science, Maths and English Olympiads for exposure. Not mandatory, but it builds the profile used later.
- Unlocks: NMMS scholarship exam in Class 8†; INSPIRE-MANAK idea awards (Class 6-10).

Class 9-10: Pre-board

- Decision: in CBSE, choose Standard or Basic Maths for Class 10. PCB itself does not need Standard Maths, but Basic Maths closes the PCMB/Engineering option later. Take Standard if undecided. CBSE relaxed the rule for 2023-24 and 2025-26 (Basic Maths students may take Maths in Class 11 if the school agrees) but it may end with the new scheme.†
- Junior Science Olympiad (NSEJS) is for Class 10 and below.
- Prerequisite for PCB: Science in Class 10 with good marks in Biology and Chemistry concepts.

After Class 10: Stream choice

- Choose PCB. Add one optional subject: Maths (PCMB, keeps engineering and biotechnology open), Computer Science (bioinformatics), Psychology, or Physical Education.
- Karnataka note: Class 11-12 is the 2-year Pre-University Course (PUC) after SSLC; CBSE/ICSE schools run Class 11-12 directly.
- NEET requires Physics, Chemistry, Biology (or Biotechnology) and English in Class 12.

Class 11-12: Preparation

- Board marks matter: minimum aggregate in PCB is part of NEET eligibility, and KCET ranking uses PUC marks.
- Apply in parallel: NEET-UG, KCET (Karnataka), CUET-UG (central universities), IISER Aptitude Test, NEST.

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After Class 12: Degree

- Medical and related: MBBS, BDS, BAMS, BHMS, BUMS, BVSc & AH (all through NEET).
- Allied: Nursing, Pharmacy, Physiotherapy, Medical Lab Technology, Optometry, Radiology.
- Science and research: BSc Life Sciences, Biotechnology, Microbiology, Genetics, Biochemistry, IISER BS-MS.
- Agriculture and environment: BSc Agriculture, Horticulture, Forestry, Fisheries.

3. Olympiads and early exams (Class 6-10)

Exam	Conducted by	Classes	Levels	Tentative timing
National Science Olympiad (NSO)	Science Olympiad Foundation (SOF)	1-12	Level 1 (school) then Level 2 (top performers)†	Level 1 Oct-Dec, Level 2 Jan-Mar†
International Mathematics Olympiad (IMO)	SOF	1-12	Level 1, Level 2	Similar to NSO†
NSEJS then INJSO (Junior Science)	IAPT then HBCSE	10 and below (age rule applies)	Stage 1 NSEJS, Stage 2 INJSO, then selection camp for IJSO†	Stage 1 Nov, Stage 2 Jan-Feb†
NSEB then INBO (Biology)	IAPT then HBCSE	11-12	Stage 1 NSEB, Stage 2 INBO, then camp for IBO†	Stage 1 Nov, Stage 2 Jan-Feb†
INSPIRE-MANAK	Dept. of Science and Technology	6-12 (Class 11-12 added; Science stream only for those)	School nominates up to 5 ideas online; district then state then national	Last cycle nominations closed 15 Sep 2025; check inspireawards-dst.gov.in for next cycle
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka: DSERT/KSEAB under Govt. of India scheme	8 (govt, aided and local body schools)	Single written test	Applications Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb (last held 1 Feb 2026); 2026-27 date not announced yet
NTSE	NCERT; Karnataka Stage 1 via DSERT	10	Stage 1 state, Stage 2 national	No sign it was discontinued, but sources are thin; 2026-27 notification expected Aug-Oct. Confirm at dsert.kar.nic.in and NCERT†

Tip for parents: Olympiads do not decide admission, but they sharpen concepts and give a ladder (school, state, national, international) that fits a Class 6 start.

4. Entrance exams after Class 10 / 12

NEET-UG (National Eligibility cum Entrance Test)	
Conducting body	National Testing Agency (NTA); official site neet.nta.nic.in
Used for	MBBS, BDS, BAMS, BHMS, BUMS, BVSc & AH, and several nursing and allied courses; AIIMS and JIPMER seats also use NEET
Minimum qualification	Class 12 with Physics, Chemistry, Biology/Biotechnology and English. Minimum aggregate in PCB: 50% General, 40% SC/ST/OBC, 45% PwBD (English not counted). The 2026 bulletin wording on this is reported unclear, and state AYUSH rules can differ.†
Age	Minimum 17 years on 31 Dec of the admission year (31 Dec 2026 for the 2026 cycle). No upper age limit is mentioned in 2026 coverage.
Frequency	Once a year
Tentative month	Registration Feb-Mar; exam normally first Sunday of May. 2026: held 3 May, cancelled 12 May after a paper leak, re-exam scheduled 21 June 2026. Dates can shift.†

Pattern	180 compulsory MCQs: Physics 45, Chemistry 45, Botany 45, Zoology 45. Total 720 marks. Pen and paper (OMR). Duration reported as 180, 195 or 200 minutes by different sources.†
Marking	+4 for correct, -1 for wrong, 0 for unattempted
Languages	13 languages including English, Hindi and Kannada; language chosen at application is final

KCET (Karnataka Common Entrance Test)	
Conducting body	Karnataka Examinations Authority (KEA); portals kea.kar.nic.in and cetonline.karnataka.gov.in
Used for	Karnataka seats in B.Pharm, BSc Agriculture, Veterinary-allied, Farm Science, Engineering, Architecture and others. Medical, dental and AYUSH seats in Karnataka use the NEET score with KEA counselling.
Minimum qualification	Class 12/2nd PUC with Physics, Chemistry and Maths/Biology; percentage criteria (commonly 45% General, 40% reserved) and domicile/Kannada rules are in the KEA brochure†
Frequency	Once a year
Tentative month	April. 2026: 23-24 April, with a Kannada language test on 22 April for eligible (Horanadu/Gadinadu Kannadiga) candidates
Pattern	Each candidate takes three papers: Physics, Chemistry and either Biology or Maths. 60 MCQs per paper (180 in total), 1 mark each, 80 minutes per paper. Offline OMR, English and Kannada.
Marking	No negative marking
Rank basis	Combination of KCET score and 2nd PUC marks (commonly 50:50)†

CUET-UG (Common University Entrance Test)	
Conducting body	NTA, cuet.nta.nic.in†
Used for	BSc and other UG programmes at Central Universities and many state/private universities; ICAR agriculture UG admissions also use CUET†
Minimum qualification	Class 12 pass; each university sets its own subject requirement
Frequency / month	Once a year; May-June†
Pattern	Computer-based. Domain papers include Biology, Chemistry, Physics, Psychology: 50 MCQs per subject, all to be attempted, 60 minutes each. Up to 5 subjects in total including languages and General Test; 250 marks per subject (50 questions at 5 marks).†
Marking	+5 correct, -1 wrong, 0 unattempted

IISER Aptitude Test (IAT)	
Conducting body	IISER consortium, iiseradmission.in†
Used for	5-year BS-MS at all seven IISERs; 4-year BS at IISER Bhopal and Tirupati; 4-year BTech at IISER Bhopal
Minimum qualification	Class 12 Science with at least three of Physics, Chemistry, Biology, Maths (Biology not compulsory); minimum 60% aggregate, 55% for SC/ST/PwD
Frequency / month	Once a year; 2026 exam was 7 June (registration closed 13 April)
Pattern	Computer-based, 3 hours, 60 MCQs (15 each: Biology, Chemistry, Maths, Physics), 240 marks
Marking	+4 correct, -1 wrong, 0 unattempted

NEST (National Entrance Screening Test)

Conducting body	NISER and UM-DAE CEBS
Used for	5-year integrated MSc in Biology and other sciences
Minimum qualification	Class 12 Science with minimum marks (about 60% General)†
Frequency / month	Once a year; typically June†
Pattern	Computer-based; sections on general, biology, chemistry, physics, maths†

Other routes (short list)

Note: NEET-UG 2026 was disrupted by a paper-leak cancellation, so applicants should follow the NTA and counselling announcements closely each year.

Exam / route	For	Note
AIIMS BSc Nursing entrance	Nursing at AIIMS institutes	Check whether replaced by NEET/CUET in current year†
BITSAT	B.Pharm at BITS Pilani	PCB route allowed for B.Pharm†
KCET / RGUHS counselling	BSc Nursing and paramedical in Karnataka	KCET (KEA) per an April 2023 government order; NEET reported as not required in Karnataka; 45% PCB General / 40% SC/ST, age 17 by 31 Dec; deemed universities (Manipal, Yenepoya) run their own tests. See Health and Allied document.†
Armed Forces Medical (AFMC)	MBBS via armed forces	Uses NEET, then AFMC selection

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
NEET-PG	NBEMS	MD/MS after MBBS	Once a year; usually mid-year†
NEET-MDS	NBEMS	MDS after BDS	Once a year†
GATE (Biotechnology / Life Sciences)	IIT-organised	MTech, PhD, PSU jobs	Feb†
IIT JAM (Biological Sciences / Biotechnology)	IIT-organised	MSc at IITs/IISc	Feb†
CSIR-UGC NET (Life Sciences)	NTA	JRF, lectureship	Twice a year†
GPAT	NTA	M.Pharm	Once a year†
CUET-PG	NTA	MSc at central universities	Once a year†

5. Scholarships

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
INSPIRE-MANAK	DST with NIF	Class 6-12, idea nominated by school (max 5 per school)	10,000 one-time	Nominations around Jul-Sep; portal inspireawards-dst.gov.in

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Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
INSPIRE-SHE	DST	Top 1% in Class 12 boards, or top 10,000 in JEE/NEET, or KVPY/NTSE/JBNSTS/Olympiad scholars, studying BSc / BS / Int. MSc in natural and basic sciences. No income limit.	80,000 per year (60,000 scholarship + 20,000 summer-project mentorship), renewable	Expected deadline 1 Dec 2026, not officially notified yet; portal online-inspire.gov.in†
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% (above 80th percentile) of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†
Corporate / foundation scholarships	Private foundations	Merit and need based	Varies	Varies by foundation†

Note: KVPY was discontinued and its role absorbed by INSPIRE-SHE and NEET/JEE based selection. Confirm before listing it anywhere.†

6. Courses and colleges

Course	Duration	Entry	Note
MBBS	4.5 yr + 1 yr internship	NEET-UG	Gateway to doctor career and MD/MS
BDS (Dental)	4 yr + 1 yr internship	NEET-UG	Dentist; MDS later
BAMS / BHMS / BUMS	4.5 yr + 1 yr internship	NEET-UG; AACCC (15%) + state counselling	AYUSH systems; see Health and Allied document
BVSc & AH	About 5 yr	NEET-UG merit (VCI)	Veterinary; 50% PCB (47.5% reserved); see Agriculture document
BSc Nursing	4 yr	KCET + KEA counselling in Karnataka†	Hospital and community nursing; see Health and Allied document
B.Pharm / Pharm.D	4 yr / 6 yr	KCET, BITSAT, state CETs	Pharma industry, hospital pharmacy
BPT (Physiotherapy)	4.5 yr	State or NEET†	Rehabilitation, sports
BSc Allied Health (MLT, Radiology, OT, Optometry)	3-4 yr	NEET reported mandatory from 2026-27 (NCAHP)†	Diagnostics and technician roles
BSc Life Sciences / Biotechnology / Microbiology / Genetics	3-4 yr	CUET-UG or university	Research and industry route
BS-MS (IISER / NISER)	5 yr	IAT, NEST	Research focused
BSc Agriculture / Horticulture / Forestry	4 yr	CUET-UG (ICAR), KCET	Agri-business, research
BTech Biotechnology / Biomedical Engineering	4 yr	JEE / KCET	Needs Maths in Class 12 (PCMB only)

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): AIIMS and JIPMER, Bangalore Medical College, St John's Medical College, Manipal and Kasturba Medical College, IISc, IISERs, NISER, Christ University, Mount Carmel College, RGUHS-affiliated colleges.†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study
Medicine	Doctor, surgeon, specialist, public-health officer, medical officer in defence	MD/MS, DM/MCh, fellowships
Dental / AYUSH / Veterinary	Dentist, ayurvedic or homeopathic physician, veterinarian	MDS, MD (AYUSH), MVSc
Nursing / Allied health	Nurse, physiotherapist, lab technologist, radiographer, optometrist	MSc, MPT, hospital management
Pharmacy	Pharmacist, drug regulatory, clinical research, pharma industry	M.Pharm, MBA, PhD
Life sciences / Biotech	Researcher, lab scientist, bioinformatician, quality analyst	MSc, PhD, CSIR/ICMR fellowships
Agriculture / Environment	Agri-officer, plant breeder, forest service, food technologist	MSc Agri, PhD, UPSC/State services

8. Related umbrellas this stream connects to

- Design: biomedical and product design (NID DAT and UCEED accept any stream; confirm current eligibility).†
- Law: CLAT is open to Science students; medical law and forensic careers combine both.
- Defence: Armed Forces Medical Services and Military Nursing Service through NEET-linked selection; NDA Army wing allows any stream but Air Force/Navy need Maths and Physics.†
- Psychology and counselling: CUET-UG with Psychology; PCB students are eligible.
- Public policy and civil services: any graduate can attempt UPSC; Science graduates often choose Medical Science or Zoology as optional subject.†

ONE-PAGE GIST: Science - PCB

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-8	Try Olympiads (NSO/IMO); Class 8: NMMS scholarship test
Class 9-10	Take Standard Maths if unsure; Junior Science Olympiad (NSEJS)
After Class 10	Choose PCB (+ Maths or Computer Science optional); PUC in Karnataka
Class 11-12	Boards + NEET-UG; also KCET, CUET-UG, IAT, NEST
After Class 12	MBBS/BDS/AYUSH/Vet via NEET; Nursing, Pharmacy, Allied, Life Sciences, Agriculture, IISER
Postgraduate	NEET-PG, NEET-MDS, GATE, JAM, CSIR-NET, GPAT

Exam	When	Pattern	Marking
NEET-UG	Once a year, May (2026 re-exam: 21 Jun)	180 Q (Phy 45, Chem 45, Bot 45, Zoo 45); 720 marks; about 3 hr 20 min	+4 / -1
KCET	Once a year, April	Phy, Chem + Maths or Bio: 60 Q each, 80 min each	+1 / 0
CUET-UG	Once a year, May-June†	Up to 5 subjects, 50 MCQs each, 60 min	+5 / -1
IAT (IISER)	Once a year, June	CBT, 3 hr, 60 Q (15 each: Bio, Chem, Maths, Phy), 240 marks	+4 / -1
NEST	Once a year, June	CBT; multi-section science test	Check notification

Eligibility for NEET: Class 12 PCB + English, minimum 50% aggregate General (40% reserved), age 17+ by 31 Dec.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8, 12,000/yr), INSPIRE-MANAK (Class 6-12, 10,000), INSPIRE-SHE (80,000/yr) and CSSS (12,000/yr) after Class 12, post-matric schemes via NSP/SSP.†

Careers: doctor, dentist, AYUSH physician, vet, nurse, physiotherapist, pharmacist, lab scientist, biotech researcher, agri-officer, public health.

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LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Science - PCM (Physics, Chemistry, Mathematics): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Start Maths and Science Olympiads; build problem-solving habit	Olympiad ladder, NMMS scholarship (Class 8)
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Take Standard Maths (CBSE) and Science; start IOQM (from Class 8) and Junior Science Olympiad	Keeps PCM open; Basic Maths students could take Maths in Class 11 in 2023-24 and 2025-26 with school approval, but the rule may end†
Stream choice	After Class 10	Choose PCM (+ optional Computer Science / Biology / Economics) in Class 11-12 (PUC in Karnataka)	Eligibility for JEE, BITSAT, KCET, NDA, B.Arch, research tracks
Preparation	Class 11-12	Boards + JEE Main / Advanced / KCET / BITSAT; Olympiads (NSE, INMO)	IIT, NIT, IIIT, BITS, state and private engineering seats
Degree	After Class 12	Engineering, architecture, pure science, data / computing, defence, aviation	Professional or research career
Postgraduate	3-6 years later	MTech, MS, MSc, MBA, PhD	Specialist and research roles
Career	-	Engineering, technology, research, defence, architecture, finance	See section 7

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-8: Foundation

- Decision: join Maths and Science Olympiads for exposure. Not mandatory, but it builds the profile and the habit used later.
- IOQM (Indian Olympiad Qualifier in Mathematics) is open from Class 8 (see section 3).
- Unlocks: NMMS scholarship exam in Class 8; INSPIRE-MANAK idea awards (Class 6-12).

Class 9-10: Pre-board

- Decision: in CBSE, choose Standard Maths for Class 10 if there is any chance of PCM, engineering or architecture. CBSE allowed Basic Maths students to take Maths in Class 11 in 2023-24 and 2025-26 if the school agrees, but the relaxation may end with the new scheme.†
- Junior Science Olympiad (NSEJS) is for Class 10 and below.
- Prerequisite for PCM: strong Class 10 Maths and Science; algebra, geometry and basic physics concepts.

After Class 10: Stream choice

- Choose PCM. Add one optional subject: Computer Science (software, data), Biology (PCMB, keeps NEET open), Economics, or Physical Education.
- Karnataka note: Class 11-12 is the 2-year Pre-University Course (PUC) after SSLC; CBSE/ICSE schools run Class 11-12 directly.
- Engineering via KCET needs Physics, Chemistry and Maths in Class 12; NDA Air Force and Navy wings also need Physics and Maths.

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Class 11-12: Preparation

- Board marks matter: KCET rank uses 50% of PUC marks, and many central institutes ask for a minimum Class 12 percentage or percentile.†
- Apply in parallel: JEE Main (two sessions), JEE Advanced (if qualified), KCET, BITSAT, COMEDK, plus NDA and other options if interested.
- Olympiad track for strong students: NSE (Physics / Chemistry / Astronomy) in Class 10-12; IOQM -> RMO -> INMO for Maths.

After Class 12: Degree

- Engineering and technology: BE / BTech through JEE, KCET, BITSAT, COMEDK and private university exams.
- Architecture: B.Arch through NATA or JEE Main Paper 2A.
- Pure science and mathematics: BSc, BS-MS (IISER / NISER / IISc), CMI, ISI (B.Stat / B.Math).
- Defence and aviation: NDA, technical entries, pilot and merchant navy routes.

3. Olympiads and early exams (Class 6-10 and beyond)

Exam	Conducted by	Classes	Levels	Timing (2026-27 cycle)
IOQM (Maths)	HBCSE with MTAI	8-12 (born 1 Aug 2007 to 31 Jul 2014)	IOQM, then RMO, then INMO, then IMO training camp and IMO selection†	IOQM held 6 Sep 2026; RMO likely 15 Nov 2026; INMO likely 17 Jan 2027†
NSE: NSEP, NSEC, NSEA (Physics, Chemistry, Astronomy)	IAPT	10-12 (born 1 Jul 2007 to 30 Jun 2012)	Stage 1 NSE, then HBCSE national olympiads (INPhO, INChO, INAO)†	Stage 1: NSEA 21 Nov, NSEP / NSEC 22 Nov 2026; INPhO about Jan-Feb 2027. Registration closed 14 Sep
NSEJS then INJSO (Junior Science)	IAPT then HBCSE	10 and below (age rule applies)	Stage 1 NSEJS, Stage 2 INJSO†	Nov, then Jan-Feb†
National Science Olympiad (NSO) / IMO	Science Olympiad Foundation (SOF)	1-12	Level 1 (school) then Level 2†	Level 1 Oct-Dec, Level 2 Jan-Mar†
INSPIRE-MANAK	DST with NIF	6-12 (Science stream for Class 11-12)	School nominates up to 5 ideas; district, state, national	Last nominations closed 15 Sep 2025; check inspireawards-dst.gov.in
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8 (govt, aided and local body schools)	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb (last held 1 Feb 2026)
NTSE	NCERT; Karnataka Stage 1 via DSERT	10	Stage 1 state, Stage 2 national	No sign of discontinuation; 2026-27 notification expected Aug-Oct†

Tip for parents: Olympiad performance can lead to direct benefits later. For example, CMI exempts outstanding national olympiad performers from its entrance test.†

4. Entrance exams after Class 10 / 12

JEE Main (Joint Entrance Examination - Main)	
Conducting body	National Testing Agency (NTA); jeemain.nta.nic.in
Used for	NITs, IIITs, other centrally funded technical institutes, many state and private colleges; also the qualifier for JEE Advanced
Eligibility to appear	Class 12 passed in 2024 or 2025, or appearing in 2026. No minimum percentage and no age limit to apply. Admission to NITs / IIITs additionally needs about 75% in Class 12 (65% for SC/ST) or top 20 percentile in the board†
Attempts	Up to three consecutive years is the usual rule†
Frequency	Two sessions a year; best score counts. 2026: Session 1 on 21-30 January, Session 2 on 2-9 April (scheduled dates)†

Pattern (Paper 1: BE / BTech)	75 questions, 300 marks, 3 hours, computer-based. 25 questions per subject: 20 MCQs + 5 numerical value questions. Reported as +4 / -1 for MCQs. Whether numerical questions carry negative marking and whether all 5 are compulsory is contested†
Paper 2	Paper 2A (B.Arch) and Paper 2B (B.Planning): 400 marks each†
Languages	English, Hindi and several regional languages†

JEE Advanced	
Conducting body	Rotates among the seven IITs; IIT Roorkee in 2026 (jeeadv.ac.in)
Used for	IITs (about 23 institutes) and related institutes via JoSAA counselling†
Eligibility	Top 2,50,000 qualifiers of JEE Main (BE / BTech); born on or after 1 Oct 2001 (5-year relaxation for SC/ST/PwD); Class 12 first appeared no earlier than the previous year; at most 2 attempts in 2 consecutive years
Frequency / date	Once a year; 2026 exam on Sunday 17 May 2026 (registration 23 Apr - 2 May); results 1 June
Pattern	Computer-based; two compulsory papers of 3 hours each (Paper 1 morning, Paper 2 afternoon); Physics, Chemistry, Mathematics. Marking varies by question type and changes yearly†

KCET (Karnataka Common Entrance Test) - Engineering	
Conducting body	Karnataka Examinations Authority (KEA); kea.kar.nic.in and cetonline.karnataka.gov.in
Used for	Engineering, architecture (with NATA), B.Pharm, farm sciences and other Karnataka professional courses
Minimum qualification	2nd PUC / Class 12 with Physics, Chemistry, Maths; at least 45% aggregate in PCM for General, 40% for reserved categories. One source says 50% for General†
Frequency / date	Once a year; 2026 exam 23-24 April (Kannada language test on 22 April for eligible candidates); results 6 June 2026
Pattern	Three papers for a PCM candidate: Physics, Chemistry and Maths, 60 MCQs each (180 in total), 1 mark each, 80 minutes per paper. Offline OMR, English and Kannada.
Marking	No negative marking
Rank basis	50% KCET score + 50% 2nd PUC marks

BITSAT (BITS Pilani)	
Conducting body	BITS Pilani (Pilani, Goa, Hyderabad campuses); admissions.bits-pilani.ac.in
Eligibility	Class 12 with Physics, Chemistry and Maths and English; aggregate and per-subject minimums apply (commonly quoted: 75% aggregate in PCM and 60% in each subject). Sources garbled, check brochure†
Frequency / date	Two sessions; 2026: Session 1 on 15-17 April, Session 2 on 24-26 May. Best score counts. Registration opens December†
Pattern	Computer-based, 3 hours, 130 MCQs: Physics, Chemistry, English Proficiency, Logical Reasoning and Mathematics (or Biology for B.Pharm)
Marking	+3 correct, -1 wrong

COMEDK UGET	
Conducting body	COMEDK (Karnataka private engineering colleges); comedk.org
Eligibility	Second PUC / Class 12 with Physics, Chemistry, Maths and English; at least 45% aggregate for General†

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Frequency / date	Once a year; 2026: 9 May in CBT mode, results 26 May
Pattern	180 marks: Physics 60, Chemistry 60, Maths 60 at 1 mark each (so about 60 questions per subject)†
Marking	No negative marking

NDA and NA (National Defence Academy / Naval Academy) - UPSC	
Conducting body	Union Public Service Commission (UPSC); upsc.gov.in
Eligibility	Class 12 pass (or appearing). Army wing: any stream. Air Force and Naval wings, and Naval Academy: Physics and Maths required. Unmarried; about 16.5 to 19.5 years of age (birth-date window changes each cycle)†
Frequency / date	Twice a year (NDA I and NDA II); NDA II 2026 written exam was on 13 September 2026. Next cycle: NDA I 2027 notification expected around December†
Pattern	Written test of 900 marks: Mathematics 300 marks and General Ability Test 600 marks, 2.5 hours each. SSB interview adds 900 marks (total 1800)
Marking	Negative marking of one-third of the question marks for wrong answers†

NATA (National Aptitude Test in Architecture)	
Conducting body	Council of Architecture (CoA); nata.in
Used for	B.Arch admissions (JEE Main Paper 2A is the alternative)
Eligibility	Passed or appearing in Class 12 with Physics and Maths. CoA minimum for B.Arch about 45% aggregate; most colleges ask for PCM and a higher percentage†
Frequency / dates	Multiple test sessions in one academic year, best score counts. 2026 reported as Phase 1 (Apr-Jun, Fri / Sat) and Phase 2 (7-8 Aug)†
Pattern	Drawing test (offline) plus an aptitude test (online)

Research-oriented and other routes

Exam / route	For	Key details
IISER Aptitude Test (IAT)	BS-MS (5 yr) at IISERs; BS / BTech at Bhopal and Tirupati	60 MCQs, 15 each (Bio, Chem, Maths, Phy), 3 hr, 240 marks, +4 / -1; need 60% (55% SC/ST/PwD) and at least three of PCMB; 2026 exam on 7 June
NEST	Integrated MSc at NISER / UM-DAE CEBS	Once a year, about June; CBT†
CMI Entrance Exam	BSc (Hons) Maths / CS / Data Science at Chennai Mathematical Institute	2026 test on 2 May; applications closed 4 April; Part A objective (40 marks), Part B descriptive (80 marks); no minimum percentage; next cycle applications about March 2027†
ISI Admission Test	B.Stat (Kolkata) and B.Math (Bengaluru) at Indian Statistical Institute	2026 test on 10 May; Maths and English compulsory in Class 12; apply by about March†
CUET-UG	BSc Physics / Maths / Chemistry / CS at central and other universities	50 MCQs per subject, 60 min, +5 / -1, computer-based; month May-June†
VITEEE, SRMJEEE and other private university exams	Private engineering universities	Dates and patterns vary by university†

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
GATE (Engineering / Science)	IIT-organised	MTech, PhD, PSU jobs	Feb†

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Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
CAT / GMAT and other management tests	IIMs / others	MBA after BTech	CAT: Nov†
IIT JAM	IIT-organised	MSc Physics, Chemistry, Maths at IITs	Feb†
CSIR-UGC NET	NTA	JRF, lectureship	Twice a year†
UPSC CSE / ESE and state PSC exams	UPSC / states	Civil and engineering services	Yearly†

5. Scholarships

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
INSPIRE-MANAK	DST with NIF	Class 6-12, idea nominated by school (max 5 per school)	10,000 one-time	Nominations around Jul-Sep; inspireawards-dst.gov.in
INSPIRE-SHE	DST	Top 1% in Class 12 boards, or top 10,000 in JEE Main / Advanced / NEET, or olympiad scholars, studying BSc / BS / Int. MSc in natural and basic sciences. No income limit.	80,000 per year (60,000 scholarship + 20,000 summer-project mentorship), renewable	Expected deadline 1 Dec 2026, not yet notified; online-inspire.gov.in†
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†
Institute and corporate scholarships	IITs, BITS, private foundations	Merit-cum-means, need based	Varies	Varies; check each institute†

Note: KVPY was discontinued and its role absorbed by INSPIRE-SHE; a few listings still mention KVPY scholars.†

6. Courses and colleges

Course	Duration	Entry	Note
BE / BTech (Computer Science, AI and Data, Electronics, Mechanical, Civil, Electrical, Chemical, Aerospace and others)	4 yr	JEE Main / Advanced, KCET, COMEDK, BITSAT, private exams	Largest PCM pathway; branch choice depends on rank
B.Arch	5 yr	NATA or JEE Main Paper 2A	Licence from Council of Architecture
BSc Physics / Chemistry / Maths / Computer Science / Statistics / Electronics	3-4 yr	CUET-UG or university	Research and teaching route; MSc and PhD later
BS-MS (IISER / NISER / IISc)	4-5 yr	IAT, NEST, IISc admission	Research focused
BSc (Hons) at CMI; B.Stat / B.Math at ISI	3 yr	CMI entrance; ISI admission test	Maths, statistics, data science; strong research pipeline
BCA / BSc Data Science / Integrated MTech	3-5 yr	CUET, university tests, JEE	Computing and data careers
NDA (Army / Navy / Air Force) then BTech / BSc	3 yr at NDA + 1 yr training	NDA exam + SSB	Officer entry, degree funded by services

Course	Duration	Entry	Note
Pilot training (CPL) / Merchant Navy (BSc Nautical, BTech Marine)	1.5-4 yr	DGCA norms; IMU CET for marine†	Physics and Maths needed in Class 12†
B.Des	4 yr	UCEED, NID DAT (any stream)	See section 8

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): IITs and IISc, NITK Surathkal, IIIT Bangalore, BITS Pilani, IISERs, ISI Bengaluru, CMI, RV College of Engineering, PES University, BMS College of Engineering, MS Ramaiah.†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study
Software and computing	Software engineer, data scientist, AI/ML engineer, cybersecurity analyst	MTech / MS, MBA, PhD
Core engineering	Mechanical, civil, electrical, electronics, chemical, aerospace engineer; PSU roles via GATE	MTech, MS, MBA, ESE / UPSC
Architecture and planning	Architect, urban planner, interior and landscape designer	M.Arch, M.Plan
Pure science and research	Physicist, chemist, mathematician, statistician, researcher, professor	MSc, PhD, CSIR / INSPIRE fellowships
Defence and aviation	Army / Navy / Air Force officer, pilot, merchant navy officer	Service training, defence technology courses
Finance and analytics	Quant analyst, actuary, data analyst, economist	MBA, actuarial exams, MSc Statistics†

8. Related umbrellas this stream connects to

- Technology / Computer Science: a large share of PCM students; BTech CSE, BCA and data science.
- Design: B.Des through UCEED and NID DAT accept students from any stream; confirm current eligibility.†
- Defence: NDA (Army wing any stream; Air Force and Navy need PCM); technical entry schemes for engineering graduates.†
- Law: CLAT is open to Science students; patent law and technology law combine both.†
- Commerce-adjacent: Economics, Actuarial Science, Management (IPMAT / CAT) welcome strong Maths students.†
- Medicine: PCMB students can keep NEET open; see the Science PCB document.

ONE-PAGE GIST: Science - PCM

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-8	Try Olympiads (IOQM from Class 8, NSO / IMO); Class 8: NMMS scholarship test
Class 9-10	Take Standard Maths; Junior Science Olympiad; build strong Maths and Physics
After Class 10	Choose PCM (+ Computer Science / Biology optional); PUC in Karnataka
Class 11-12	Boards + JEE Main (2 sessions) -> JEE Advanced; also KCET, BITSAT, COMEDK; NSE / INMO for strong students
After Class 12	BE / BTech, B.Arch, BSc / BS-MS (IISER, CMI, ISI), NDA, pilot or merchant navy, BCA / Data Science
Postgraduate	GATE, JAM, CAT, UPSC, CSIR-NET

Exam	When	Pattern	Marking
JEE Main	Jan and Apr sessions	75 Q, 300 marks, 3 hr CBT; 25 per subject	+4 / -1 (numerical: check)
JEE Advanced	May (2026: 17 May)	2 papers, 3 hr each, CBT; top 2.5 lakh of JEE Main	Varies by question
KCET	April (2026: 23-24)	Phy, Chem, Maths: 60 Q each, 80 min each	+1 / 0
BITSAT	Apr and May sessions	130 Q, 3 hr CBT	+3 / -1
COMEDK	May (2026: 9 May)	180 marks: P / C / M 60 each	+1 / 0
NDA	Twice a year	Maths 300 + GAT 600; SSB 900	1/3 negative

Key rules: KCET rank = 50% KCET + 50% PUC marks; KCET needs about 45% PCM (General). JEE Advanced needs JEE Main top 2.5 lakh, max 2 attempts.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8, 12,000/yr), INSPIRE-MANAK (Class 6-12, 10,000), INSPIRE-SHE (80,000/yr) and CSSS (12,000/yr) after Class 12, post-matric schemes via NSP / SSP.†

Careers: engineer (software, core, aerospace), architect, scientist, statistician, defence officer, pilot, data scientist, analyst.

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LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Commerce (Accountancy, Business Studies, Economics): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Build Maths, English and money sense; try Maths Olympiad (IOQM from Class 8)	Olympiad ladder, NMMS scholarship (Class 8)
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Take Standard Maths if unsure; understand commerce streams	Keeps Economics Hons, IPM, Actuarial and Statistics open
Stream choice	After Class 10	Commerce with Maths, or without Maths (Accountancy, Business Studies, Economics + one of Maths / Informatics / English / Statistics)	Course eligibility differs: some need Maths in Class 12
Professional track	Class 11-12 onward	Choose CA, CS, CMA, or a degree track (BCom, BBA, BA Economics)	Foundation exams can start after Class 12
Degree / exams	After Class 12	BCom / BBA / IPM / BA LLB / Actuarial / ACCA with a professional course alongside	Professional licence or management career
Postgraduate	3-5 years later	MBA, MCom, MA Economics, LLM, CFA, specialisations	Senior finance, management, policy, research roles
Career	-	Finance, accounting, management, law, economics, entrepreneurship	See section 7

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-8: Foundation

- Decision: strengthen Maths and English; join Olympiads for problem-solving. There is no single formal Commerce olympiad, so Maths and English Olympiads are the useful early signals.†
- Unlocks: NMMS scholarship test in Class 8; IOQM (Maths Olympiad) from Class 8.

Class 9-10: Pre-board

- Decision: in CBSE, choose Standard Maths for Class 10 if there is any chance of Economics Hons, IPM, Actuarial Science, Statistics or CA with a Maths-heavy profile.†
- Explore: personal finance, accounts basics, economics concepts from the Class 9-10 Social Science syllabus.

After Class 10: Stream choice

- Choose Commerce. Core subjects: Accountancy, Business Studies, Economics, English. Add one: Mathematics, Informatics Practices / Computer Science, Statistics or Physical Education.
- Take Mathematics if you want: BA / BSc Economics (Hons), IPM (IIM Indore / Rohtak), Actuarial Science, B.Stat, B.Com (Hons) at some universities, or a data-driven finance career.
- Karnataka note: Class 11-12 is the 2-year Pre-University Course (PUC) after SSLC; CBSE/ICSE schools run Class 11-12 directly.

Class 11-12: Preparation

- Board marks matter: BCom admission in Karnataka is mostly merit-based on 2nd PUC / Class 12 marks. CA Foundation registration must be done at least four months before the exam.†

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- Apply in parallel: CUET-UG (central universities), IPMAT, CLAT, SET / NPAT and college tests; register for CA / CS / CMA Foundation or entrance as per calendar.

After Class 12: Degree and professional courses

- Professional: CA, CS, CMA (can be pursued alongside BCom).
- Degrees: BCom (General / Hons / Professional), BBA / BMS, BA / BSc Economics, BA LLB / BBA LLB, BSc Statistics / Actuarial Science, 5-year IPM.
- International certifications: ACCA, CFA.

3. Olympiads and early exams (Class 6-10 and beyond)

Exam	Conducted by	Classes	Levels	Timing (2026-27 cycle)
IOQM (Maths)	HBCSE with MTAI	8-12 (born 1 Aug 2007 to 31 Jul 2014)	IOQM, then RMO, then INMO	IOQM held 6 Sep 2026; RMO / INMO later†
International Mathematics Olympiad (IMO) / English Olympiad (IEO)	Science Olympiad Foundation (SOF)	1-12	Level 1 (school) then Level 2†	Level 1 Oct-Dec, Level 2 Jan-Mar†
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8 (govt, aided and local body schools)	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb (last held 1 Feb 2026)
NTSE	NCERT; Karnataka Stage 1 via DSERT	10 (covers Social Science too)	Stage 1 state, Stage 2 national	No sign of discontinuation; 2026-27 notification expected Aug-Oct†
INSPIRE-MANAK	DST with NIF	6-12	School nominates up to 5 ideas	Last nominations closed 15 Sep 2025; check inspireawards-dst.gov.in†

Tip for parents: Commerce has fewer early exams than Science, so school Maths, English, public speaking, and business-related projects (school enterprise or finance clubs) build the profile.

4. Professional courses and entrance exams

CA (Chartered Accountancy) - ICAI: Foundation level	
Conducting body	Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI); icai.org
Stages	Foundation -> Intermediate -> Articleship (practical training) -> Final
Eligibility	Class 12 pass from a recognised board; can register while in Class 12 if finished before the exam. Reported: Class 10 passers can register provisionally. Register at least four months before the exam†
Frequency	Foundation reported thrice a year (January, May/June, September); September 2026 papers were scheduled for 2, 5, 7 and 9 September (offline)†
Pattern	4 papers of 100 marks (400): Paper 1 Accounting and Paper 2 Business Laws (subjective); Paper 3 Business Mathematics, Logical Reasoning and Statistics and Paper 4 Business Economics (objective MCQs, 0.25 negative marking)
Passing	At least 40% in each paper and 50% aggregate†
Later stages	Intermediate exams reported three times a year (Jan, May, Sep); articleship reported as 3 years, with a shorter two-year model under the new scheme from Sep 2026; Final frequency reported as twice or thrice a year. All conflict across sources†

CS (Company Secretary) - ICSI: CSEET	
Conducting body	Institute of Company Secretaries of India (ICSI); icsi.edu
Eligibility	Indian nationals who have passed Class 12 (appearing candidates can also apply)†

Frequency	Previously four sessions a year (Jan, May, Jul, Nov); ICSI announced three sessions a year (February, June, October) from the June 2026 session. June 2026 session ran 1-4 June. October 2026 dates not confirmed†
Pattern	Revised pattern reported as four 100-mark papers (Business Communication; Fundamentals of Accounting; Economic and Business Environment; Business Laws and Management), centre-based pen-and-paper over four days. Older pattern was 200 marks. Sources conflict†
Later stages	Executive -> Professional programmes with practical training

CMA (Cost and Management Accountant) - ICMAI: Foundation	
Conducting body	Institute of Cost Accountants of India (ICMAI); eicmai.in
Eligibility	Class 12 pass (or appearing, with provisional registration)†
Frequency	Twice a year (June and December). June 2026 exam on 14 June; December 2026 tentatively mid-December, with the no-late-fee form deadline reported as 14 Oct 2026†
Pattern	4 papers, MCQ-based, OMR; reported as pass with 40% in each paper and 50% aggregate†
Fee	About 6,000 (reported)†
Later stages	Foundation -> Intermediate -> Final with practical training

IPMAT (Integrated Programme in Management Aptitude Test)	
Conducting body	IIM Indore (also IIM Rohtak with its own test); iimidr.ac.in and iimrohtak.ac.in
Used for	5-year integrated programme in management (BBA + MBA) at IIM Indore and IIM Rohtak
Eligibility	Indore: born on or after 1 Aug 2006 (5-year relaxation SC/ST/PwD); Class 12 passed or appearing in 2024-2026; minimum marks reported as none by one source and 60% by another. Rohtak: born on or after 30 Jun 2005; 60% in Class 10 and 12 (55% reserved)†
Frequency / date	Once a year; 2026: Indore on 4 May, Rohtak on 10 May
Pattern (Indore)	Computer-based, 2 hours: Quantitative Ability MCQ, Quantitative Ability short answer, Verbal Ability MCQ; +4 / -1 for MCQs. Rohtak pattern not confirmed†

CUET-UG (for BCom and other degrees at central and other universities)	
Conducting body	NTA, cuet.nta.nic.in
Used for	BCom, BCom (Hons), BA Economics and BBA seats at Delhi University, BHU, Allahabad University and others
Subjects	Typically a language, plus three domain subjects (Accountancy / Book Keeping, Business Studies, Economics, Mathematics / Applied Mathematics) or one domain subject + General Aptitude Test; combinations vary by university; BCom (Hons) often asks for Maths or Accountancy†
Pattern / marking	Computer-based; 50 MCQs per domain subject, 60 minutes, +5 / -1 (see Science documents)
Frequency / month	Once a year; May-June†

CLAT (Common Law Admission Test) - for BA LLB / BBA LLB	
Conducting body	Consortium of National Law Universities; consortiumofnlus.ac.in
Eligibility	Class 12 or equivalent (appearing candidates allowed); about 45% for General (40% SC/ST)†
Frequency / date	Once a year; CLAT 2027 expected 6 December 2026, application deadline reported as 31 October 2026 (official notification not seen)†

Pattern	120 MCQs, 2 hours, offline: English, Current Affairs / GK, Legal Reasoning, Logical Reasoning, Quantitative Techniques; +1 / -0.25. A committee may revise the pattern†

ACET (Actuarial Common Entrance Test) - Institute of Actuaries of India	
Conducting body	Institute and Faculty of Actuaries India / Institute of Actuaries of India (IAI); actuariesindia.org
Eligibility	Class 12 pass or appearing; sources conflict on whether English or Mathematics is required†
Frequency / date	Held twice a year in some years; 2026 exam on 13 June (results 23 June)†
Pattern	Online, 3 hours, 70 MCQs on Mathematics, Statistics, Data Interpretation, English and Logical Reasoning. Score valid for three years

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
BCom admission in Karnataka (BCU and other universities)	BCom General / Hons	Mostly merit-based on 2nd PUC / Class 12 marks with no entrance exam; Christ and some deemed universities run their own admission process; some colleges ask 50%†
SET, NPAT, Christ University tests and college-specific tests	BBA / BMS at Symbiosis, NMIMS, Christ and similar	SET reported for May and NPAT for Mar-May 2026; dates and registration windows change every year†
ACCA	Global accountancy qualification	Class 12 students may enter directly if they meet marks rules (reported as English plus Maths or Accounts; marks thresholds conflict); otherwise ACCA Foundations route†
CFA (CFA Institute)	Investment and finance credential	Exam windows and eligibility not confirmed at the time of compilation; usually pursued during or after degree†
Banking, insurance and government jobs	After graduation	IBPS / SBI / RBI / SSC / UPSC exams; not covered at the time of compilation†

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
CAT / XAT / GMAT and other management tests	IIMs / others	MBA / PGDM	CAT: Nov†
CUET-PG / university entrance	NTA / universities	MCom, MA / MSc Economics	Once a year†
CA Final / CS Professional / CMA Final	ICAI / ICSI / ICMAI	Qualified professional	Per institute calendar†
CFA Levels I-III	CFA Institute	Investment careers	Multiple windows†
UGC-NET (Commerce / Economics)	NTA	Lectureship and research	Twice a year†

5. Scholarships

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream (Commerce counts as its own stream); family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†
ICAI / ICSI / ICMAI and corporate scholarships	Institutes and foundations	Merit and need based	Varies	Check each institute†

Note: INSPIRE-SHE is for natural and basic sciences, so Commerce students are generally not eligible for it.†

6. Courses and colleges

Course	Duration	Entry	Note
BCom (General / Hons / Professional / Accounting and Taxation / International Finance)	3-4 yr	Merit in Karnataka; CUET-UG for central universities	Common base for CA / CS / CMA preparation
BBA / BMS	3-4 yr	SET, NPAT, college tests, merit, CUET	Management foundation; MBA later
IPM (Integrated BBA + MBA)	5 yr	IPMAT (Indore, Rohtak) and similar	Direct route to IIM campuses
BA / BSc Economics (Hons)	3-4 yr	CUET-UG or college tests; Maths often needed	Policy, banking, research
BA LLB / BBA LLB	5 yr	CLAT and other law entrances	See section 8
BSc Statistics / Actuarial Science	3 yr	University merit or CUET; ACET for IAI route	Maths required in Class 12
CA / CS / CMA (with BCom)	4-5 yr (varies)	Foundation / CSEET exams as above	Professional licence
ACCA / CFA	Self-paced (3-4 yr+)	Direct entry rules†	Global credentials

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): Christ University, St Joseph's, Mount Carmel, Jain University, Bangalore University / BCU affiliated colleges, Shri Ram College of Commerce (DU), IIM Indore and Rohtak (IPM), NMIMS, Symbiosis, NLSIU Bengaluru (Law).†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study
Accounting and audit	Chartered accountant, auditor, tax consultant, forensic accountant, financial controller	CA Final, DISA, MBA, CFA
Corporate governance	Company secretary, compliance officer, corporate lawyer	CS Professional, LLB / LLM, MBA
Cost and management	Cost accountant, FP&A, strategy and operations roles	CMA Final, MBA
Finance and banking	Investment banker, equity analyst, banker, insurance professional, fintech roles	MBA Finance, CFA, FRM
Management and entrepreneurship	Business manager, consultant, marketer, start-up founder	MBA / PGDM, executive programmes
Economics and policy	Economist, researcher, policy analyst, civil servant	MA / MSc Economics, PhD, UPSC
Law and compliance	Corporate, tax and IP lawyer	LLM, judicial services
Actuarial and analytics	Actuary, risk analyst, data analyst in finance	IAI actuarial exams, MSc Statistics†

8. Related umbrellas this stream connects to

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- Law: CLAT is open to Commerce students; BBA LLB / BA LLB, corporate and tax law combine both.
- Management: IPM, BBA / BMS, then MBA; entrepreneurship and family business.
- Humanities and Economics: BA Economics, public policy, civil services (UPSC accepts any graduate).
- Technology / Data: fintech, analytics, accounting software; Commerce with Maths or Informatics Practices opens BCA / BSc Data Science.†
- Design: B.Des through UCEED and NID DAT accept students from any stream; marketing and brand design overlap with Commerce.†
- Defence: NDA Army wing accepts any stream; Air Force and Navy need Physics and Maths.†

ONE-PAGE GIST: Commerce

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-8	Build Maths and English; try IOQM from Class 8; Class 8: NMMS scholarship test
Class 9-10	Take Standard Maths if unsure; learn basic accounts and economics
After Class 10	Choose Commerce (+ Maths for Economics Hons, IPM, Actuarial); PUC in Karnataka
Class 11-12	Boards; register for CA / CS / CMA Foundation; apply to CUET, IPMAT, CLAT, SET / NPAT
After Class 12	BCom / BBA / IPM / BA Economics / BA LLB; CA, CS, CMA alongside; ACCA / CFA
Postgraduate	MBA (CAT), MCom / MA Economics, LLM, CFA, CA Final

Exam	When	Pattern	Marking
CA Foundation	Jan, May/Jun, Sep	4 papers x 100; Papers 1-2 subjective, 3-4 objective	0.25 negative in objective
CSEET (ICSI)	Feb, Jun, Oct†	Four 100-mark papers (revised)†	Check notification
CMA Foundation	June and December	4 papers, MCQ, OMR	40% each, 50% total
IPMAT	May (Indore 4 May 2026)	2 hr: Quant MCQ + Quant SA + Verbal	+4 / -1 MCQ
CLAT	December (2027 expected 6 Dec 2026)	120 MCQs, 2 hr	+1 / -0.25
CUET-UG	May-June†	50 MCQs per subject, 60 min	+5 / -1

Key rules: CA / CS / CMA Foundation open after Class 12 (register early); BCom in Karnataka is mostly merit-based on 2nd PUC marks; Maths in Class 12 keeps IPM, Economics Hons and Actuarial open.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8, 12,000/yr), CSSS (12,000/yr UG), post-matric schemes via NSP / SSP.†

Careers: chartered accountant, company secretary, cost accountant, auditor, banker, analyst, manager, economist, corporate lawyer, actuary, entrepreneur.

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LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Arts and Humanities (History, Political Science, Psychology, Languages, Design, Media): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Build reading, writing, speaking and curiosity about people and society; try debate, art, languages	Olympiad ladder, NMMS scholarship (Class 8)
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Explore interests (history, law, psychology, design, media, teaching); keep Standard Maths if possible	Keeps Economics Hons, Design (NID / NIFT) and other options open
Stream choice	After Class 10	Choose Arts / Humanities subjects in Class 11-12 (PUC in Karnataka)	Eligibility for CUET-UG, CLAT, UCEED, NID, NCET, liberal arts tests
Preparation	Class 11-12	Boards + the target entrance (CUET, CLAT, UCEED, NID DAT, NCET, college tests)	Merit seats and scholarships
Degree	After Class 12	BA, BA LLB, B.Des, BJMC, ITEP, Liberal Arts, BFA, Hotel Management	Professional or academic career
Postgraduate	3-5 years later	MA / MSc, MBA, LLM, M.Des, MSW, B.Ed, PhD	Specialist, teaching and research roles
Career	-	Civil services, law, psychology, media, design, teaching, research, hospitality	See section 7

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-8: Foundation

- Decision: read widely, write, speak and observe. Join debate, quiz, art, drama, language and community activities.
- Unlocks: NMMS scholarship test in Class 8; English / Social Science olympiads for exposure.†

Class 9-10: Pre-board

- Decision: keep Standard Maths in Class 10 (CBSE) if there is any chance of Economics, Psychology (Statistics), Design or a later change of stream.†
- NTSE (Class 10) covers Social Science and Mental Ability as well as Science and Maths.†

After Class 10: Stream choice

- Choose Arts / Humanities. Typical subjects: History, Political Science, Geography, Economics, Psychology, Sociology, Languages, Fine Arts, Home Science, Mass Communication.
- Add Mathematics or Statistics if you want Economics Hons, quantitative Psychology, or flexibility toward design technology. Karnataka PUC offers fixed combinations; confirm with the college.†
- Karnataka note: Class 11-12 is the 2-year Pre-University Course (PUC) after SSLC; CBSE/ICSE schools run Class 11-12 directly.

Class 11-12: Preparation

- Board marks matter: BA admission in Karnataka is mostly merit-based on 2nd PUC / Class 12 marks.†

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- Apply in parallel: CUET-UG (central universities), CLAT (law), UCEED / NID DAT / NIFT (design), NCET (teaching), liberal arts tests (FLAME FEAT, Ashoka AAA, Azim Premji), SET / college tests.

After Class 12: Degree

- Academic: BA (History, Political Science, Economics, Sociology, Psychology, English, Kannada and other languages), 4-year honours / research options.
- Professional: BA LLB, B.Des, BJMC / BA Media, ITEP (BA B.Ed), Hotel Management (BSc), BFA, BSW.
- Liberal Arts at FLAME, Ashoka, Azim Premji, Krea and similar universities.

3. Olympiads and early exams (Class 6-10 and beyond)

Exam	Conducted by	Classes	Levels	Timing (2026-27 cycle)
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8 (govt, aided and local body schools)	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb (last held 1 Feb 2026)
NTSE	NCERT; Karnataka Stage 1 via DSERT	10 (includes Social Science)	Stage 1 state, Stage 2 national	No sign of discontinuation; 2026-27 notification expected Aug-Oct†
English Olympiad (IEO) and similar	Science Olympiad Foundation (SOF)	1-12	Level 1 (school) then Level 2†	Level 1 Oct-Dec, Level 2 Jan-Mar†
INSPIRE-MANAK	DST with NIF	6-12	School nominates up to 5 ideas	Last nominations closed 15 Sep 2025; check inspireawards-dst.gov.in†

Tip for parents: Humanities has few formal olympiads. Debate, MUN, quizzing, essay and art competitions, theatre, and school magazines build the profile that colleges and liberal arts universities look for.

4. Entrance exams after Class 10 / 12

UPSC Civil Services Examination (after graduation)	
Conducting body	Union Public Service Commission (UPSC); upsc.gov.in
Used for	IAS, IFS, IPS and other central services; IFoS prelims is taken in the same sitting
Eligibility	Graduation from a recognised university (final-year students may apply). Age: minimum 21; maximum 32 for General (relaxations for OBC, SC/ST, PwBD). Attempts: General 6, OBC 9, SC/ST unlimited (within age limit). Indian citizenship for IAS / IFS / IPS†
Frequency / dates	Once a year. CSE 2027 per UPSC calendar: notification 13 January 2027, applications close 2 February, Prelims 23 May 2027, Mains from 20 August 2027†
Pattern	Prelims: GS Paper 1 (100 questions, 200 marks, counts for merit) and CSAT Paper 2 (qualifying, 33%). Then Mains and Interview†
Karnataka	State civil services are held by the Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC)†

CUET-UG (for BA at central and other universities)	
Conducting body	NTA, cuet.nta.nic.in
Subjects	23 domain subjects including History, Political Science, Geography, Psychology, Sociology, Fine Arts, Mass Communication; mapping is set by each university and programme, often English + one or more domain subjects + General Aptitude Test†
Pattern / marking	Computer-based; 50 MCQs per domain subject, 60 minutes, +5 / -1 (see Science documents)
Frequency / month	Once a year; May-June†

UCEED (Undergraduate Common Entrance Exam for Design) - IIT Bombay	
Conducting body	IIT Bombay; uceed.iitb.ac.in
Used for	B.Des at IITs (Bombay, Delhi, Guwahati, Hyderabad) and IIITDM Jabalpur†
Eligibility	Any stream. Class 12 (or equivalent) passed in 2026 or 2027 (first appeared in 2025 or earlier is not eligible). Born on or after 1 Oct 2002 (1 Oct 1997 for SC/ST/PwD)
Frequency / dates	Once a year; UCEED 2027 exam reported for 17 January 2027 (3 hours); registration reported 1-31 October 2026, though one source gives 21 October as the deadline†

NID DAT (National Institute of Design Design Aptitude Test)	
Conducting body	National Institute of Design (NID); admissions.nid.edu
Eligibility	B.Des: 10+2 from any recognised board; Maths recommended, all streams may apply; no upper age limit. Final Class 12 marksheet by 15 July 2027†
Frequency / dates	Once a year; applications reported 10 Sep - 30 Nov 2026, DAT Prelims 20 December 2026; sources disagree†
Pattern	Prelims, then Mains with studio tests and interview†

NIFT (National Institute of Fashion Technology)	
Conducting body	NIFT with NTA; nift.ac.in
Eligibility	B.Des: Class 12 in any stream. B.FTech: Mathematics required (Physics and Maths per one source). UG age: under 24 on 1 Aug 2027, 5-year relaxation SC/ST/PwD†
Pattern	GAT (General Ability Test) and CAT (Creative Ability Test), then Situation Test / interview for some courses†
Frequency / dates	Once a year; 2027 dates not yet published†

NCET (National Common Entrance Test) - Integrated Teacher Education Programme (ITEP)	
Conducting body	NTA; exams.nta.nic.in/ncet
Used for	4-year integrated BA B.Ed / BSc B.Ed at about 223 institutions (about 16,950 seats reported)
Eligibility	Class 12 passed or appearing; minimum age 18 reported by one source†
Frequency / dates	Once a year; 2026 exam held 17-18 April, results 4 June 2026
Pattern	Computer-based, about 180 minutes: two languages (from 38), up to three domain subjects (from 26), teaching aptitude and a general test; MCQs with negative marking; 13 mediums. Question count reported as 181 (attempt 160)†

CTET and KARTET (teacher eligibility)	
Conducting body	CBSE (CTET, ctet.nic.in); Karnataka School Education Department (KARTET)
Eligibility	CTET Paper I (Classes 1-5): Class 12 with 50% + 2-year D.El.Ed or equivalent (4-year B.El.Ed also reported); Paper II (Classes 6-8): degree + B.Ed / equivalent†
Frequency / dates	CTET twice a year; February 2026 session on 7-8 February with re-exam for cancelled centres on 1 March; next session reported for 6 September 2026†. KARTET 2025 was held on 7 December 2025; 2026 notification not yet seen†
Pattern	CTET: offline OMR; 150 MCQs per paper, 150 marks, 2 hours 30 minutes, no negative marking; certificate validity reported as lifetime. KARTET: Paper 1 (Classes 1-5), Paper 2 (Classes 6-8)†

NCHM JEE (Hotel Management)	
Conducting body	NTA for the National Council for Hotel Management; exams.nta.nic.in/nchm-jee
Eligibility	10+2 with English; no age limit; appearing candidates can apply; no stream restriction stated (inferred)†
Frequency / dates	Once a year; 2026 exam on 25 April (CBT, 120 cities)
Pattern	Computer-based; about 3 hours reported; section-wise breakdown not confirmed†

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
CLAT	BA LLB / BBA LLB at National Law Universities	Class 12 pass, about 45% (40% SC/ST); 120 MCQs, 2 hr, +1 / -0.25; CLAT 2027 expected 6 Dec 2026, official notice not seen†. See Commerce document.
Liberal arts: FLAME FEAT or SAT / ACT	FLAME University	Online aptitude test (FEAT) plus essay, or SAT / ACT score with essay; final 2026 cycle test window reported 6-10 June†
Ashoka Aptitude Assessment (AAA) + On-the-Spot Essay	Ashoka University	Own test; SAT, ACT, CUET or JEE scores optional extras; no minimum percentage reported†
Azim Premji University National Entrance Test	BA / BSc programmes in Bengaluru	2026 intake test on 14 Dec 2025 with interviews 5-9 Jan 2026; age up to 21 on 31 July (exceptions possible)†
Krea University and other private universities	Liberal arts degrees	Not confirmed at the time of compilation†
Media: SET, Christ University tests, CUET-UG	BA Mass Communication / Media Studies / Journalism	Symbiosis route via SET; Christ via own test + CUET per one source; IIMC admits to MA / PG diploma through CUET-PG only†
BA admission in Karnataka (BCU and other universities)	BA with chosen combinations	Mostly merit-based on 2nd PUC / Class 12; no entrance exam for most colleges†
Fine and performing arts (BFA, music, dance, drama)	Visual and performing arts degrees	Entrance requirements not confirmed (for example Karnataka Chitrakala Parishath)†

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
CUET-PG	NTA	MA at central universities and IIMC MA programmes	Once a year†
UGC-NET	NTA	Lectureship, JRF in humanities subjects	Twice a year†
B.Ed / M.Ed entrance and teacher tests	Universities / states	School teaching	Varies†
CAT / XAT and other management tests	IIMs / others	MBA after BA	CAT: Nov†
TISS and other social work / policy entrance	TISS and others	MSW, development studies	Varies†

5. Scholarships

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream (Humanities counts as its own stream); family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†
University and foundation scholarships	Ashoka, FLAME, Azim Premji, others	Merit and need based	Varies	Check each university†

Note: INSPIRE-SHE is for natural and basic sciences, so Humanities students are generally not eligible for it.†

6. Courses and colleges

Course	Duration	Entry	Note
BA (History, Political Science, Sociology, Economics, Psychology, English, Kannada, Geography and other combinations)	3-4 yr	Merit in Karnataka; CUET-UG for central universities	Base for civil services, teaching, research, policy
BA Psychology, then MA / MSc Psychology	3-4 yr + 2 yr	Merit or CUET; PG entrance varies	RCI registration needed for clinical practice (see section 7)
BA LLB / BBA LLB	5 yr	CLAT and other law tests	See Commerce document
B.Des (IIT / NID / NIFT / private)	4 yr	UCEED, NID DAT, NIFT	Product, communication, fashion, UX
BJMC / BA Mass Communication / Media Studies	3 yr	CUET, SET, college tests	Journalism, PR, digital media
ITEP (BA B.Ed)	4 yr	NCET	School teaching route
Liberal Arts (BA / BSc Hons, 3-4 yr)	3-4 yr	FEAT, AAA, Azim Premji NET, SAT / ACT	Interdisciplinary, research and policy
BSc Hospitality / Hotel Management	3-4 yr	NCHM JEE and college tests	Hotels, aviation hospitality, events
BFA / performing arts / BSW	3-4 yr	College entrance or portfolio†	Creative and social sectors

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): Delhi University and JNU (via CUET), Christ University, St Joseph's, Mount Carmel, Azim Premji University, Ashoka University, FLAME University, NLSIU Bengaluru (Law), IIT Bombay / IIT Delhi (B.Des), NID Bengaluru, NIFT Bengaluru, Karnataka Chitrakala Parishath.†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study
Civil services and public policy	IAS / IFS / IPS officer, state services, policy analyst, diplomat	UPSC / KPSC, MPP, MA Public Administration
Law	Lawyer, judge, legal advisor, human rights specialist	LLM, judicial services exams
Psychology and counselling	Counsellor, school psychologist, HR professional; clinical psychologist needs RCI registration and an RCI-approved clinical qualification (M.Phil vs RCI-approved MA is reported inconsistently; 4-year BA or 3+1 bridge also reported)†	MA / MSc Psychology, clinical qualification, PhD
Media and communication	Journalist, editor, content creator, PR and advertising professional	MA Mass Communication (IIMC via CUET-PG), PG diplomas
Design	Product, UX, graphic, fashion, communication designer	M.Des, MBA in design management
Teaching and education	School teacher (via CTET / KARTET), lecturer, education researcher	B.Ed, M.Ed, MA, UGC-NET, PhD

Path	Job roles	Higher study
Research and academia	Historian, sociologist, economist, linguist, archaeologist, professor	MA, MPhil, PhD, UGC-NET
Hospitality, arts and social sector	Hotel and tourism manager, artist, performer, social worker, NGO leader	MSW, MBA, specialised diplomas

8. Related umbrellas this stream connects to

- Law: CLAT is open to Humanities students; BA LLB and judicial services are common routes.
- Management and Commerce: BBA, IPM and MBA accept Humanities graduates (see Commerce document); Economics Hons needs Maths in some universities.†
- Design and Technology: UCEED and NID accept all streams; UX, digital media and human-centred design combine Humanities with technology.
- Defence: NDA Army wing accepts any stream; Air Force and Navy need Physics and Maths.†
- Education: ITEP, B.Ed and TET exams lead to school teaching.
- Health and Social care: Psychology, social work, special education and counselling overlap with allied health.†

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ONE-PAGE GIST: Arts and Humanities

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-8	Read, write, debate, create; Class 8: NMMS scholarship test
Class 9-10	Explore interests; keep Standard Maths if possible; NTSE (Class 10)
After Class 10	Choose Arts / Humanities subjects (History, Pol Sci, Psychology, Economics, Languages); PUC in Karnataka
Class 11-12	Boards + CUET-UG; CLAT, UCEED, NID DAT, NIFT, NCET, FLAME / Ashoka / Azim Premji tests as targeted
After Class 12	BA, BA LLB, B.Des, BJMC, ITEP, Liberal Arts, Hotel Management, BFA; Civil services preparation can begin early
Postgraduate	MA, MSc Psychology, LLM, M.Des, B.Ed / M.Ed, MBA, UGC-NET, UPSC after graduation

Exam	When	Pattern	Marking
UPSC CSE	Prelims May (2027: 23 May); after graduation	GS 200 marks + CSAT (qualifying 33%), then Mains, Interview	Negative marking in Prelims†
CUET-UG	May-June†	50 MCQs per subject, 60 min	+5 / -1
CLAT	December (2027: expected 6 Dec 2026)	120 MCQs, 2 hr	+1 / -0.25
UCEED	January (2027: 17 Jan)	3 hours, any stream	Check brochure
NID DAT	Prelims Dec 2026†	Prelims then Mains / studio	Check brochure
NCET (ITEP)	April (2026: 17-18 April)	CBT, about 180 min; languages + domains + aptitude	MCQs with negative marking

Key rules: UPSC needs a graduation, age 21-32 (General), 6 attempts; BA in Karnataka is mostly merit-based on 2nd PUC marks; UCEED, NID and NIFT B.Des accept all streams.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8, 12,000/yr), CSSS (12,000/yr UG), post-matric schemes via NSP / SSP, university scholarships.†

Careers: civil servant, lawyer, psychologist, journalist, designer, teacher, researcher, hospitality manager, artist, social worker.

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LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Law (Advocate, Judge, Corporate Counsel, Legal Careers): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Build reading, writing, debate and reasoning; follow current affairs	Skills tested later in CLAT / AILET (English, GK, Logical Reasoning)
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Explore interest in law; any stream is fine later	Law is open to Science, Commerce and Humanities students
Stream choice	After Class 10	Any stream in Class 11-12 (Humanities is common; Commerce and Science are also eligible)	CLAT, AILET, SLAT and other law entrance eligibility
Preparation	Class 11-12	Boards + law entrance tests (CLAT, AILET, SLAT, LSAT India)	Seats at National Law Universities and private law schools
Degree	After Class 12	5-year integrated BA LLB / BBA LLB / BCom LLB; or 3-year LLB after any graduation	Eligibility to enrol with the State Bar Council
Licence	After LLB	Enrol with State Bar Council, then pass AIBE for Certificate of Practice	Right to practise as an advocate
Specialise / serve	1-5 years later	Litigation, corporate, judiciary, LLM, public service	Senior counsel, judge, in-house counsel, academia

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-10: Foundation

- Decision: strengthen English, current affairs, logical reasoning and public speaking. Join debate, MUN, quiz and moot-style activities.
- There is no separate law exam before Class 12. Skills built now are tested in CLAT and AILET.

After Class 10: Stream choice

- Any stream works. Humanities (History, Political Science, Economics) helps with GK and legal reasoning; Commerce helps with corporate law; Science with IP, patent and cyber law.
- Karnataka note: Class 11-12 is the 2-year Pre-University Course (PUC) after SSLC; CBSE/ICSE schools run Class 11-12 directly.

Class 11-12: Preparation

- Prepare for CLAT (December), AILET (December), SLAT and other tests alongside boards; apply by the notification deadlines (typically Aug-Nov).
- Read a newspaper daily; practise passage-based reading, legal reasoning and quantitative techniques.

After Class 12: Degree

- 5-year integrated degrees: BA LLB (Hons), BBA LLB, BCom LLB. 3-year LLB is available after any graduation.
- Choice between National Law Universities (CLAT / AILET), state law universities (Karnataka: KSLU and affiliated colleges), and private law schools.

After the degree: Licence and career

- Enrol with the State Bar Council; clear the All India Bar Examination (AIBE) to get the Certificate of Practice from the Bar Council of India.
- Paths: litigation, corporate law firms, in-house counsel, judiciary (civil judge exams), public prosecutor, legal policy, academia, LLM and PhD.

3. Early preparation (Class 6-12)

Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
Debate, MUN, moot and quiz competitions	Schools, colleges, NGOs	6-12	Builds speaking, reasoning and awareness; no formal entrance value	Through the year
NTSE	NCERT; Karnataka Stage 1 via DSERT	10	Covers Social Science and mental ability	2026-27 notification expected Aug-Oct†
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb

Tip for parents: law entrance scores depend on reading speed, vocabulary, current affairs and logic. Start newspaper reading and reasoning practice in Class 8-9.

4. Entrance exams, licensing and judicial services

CLAT (Common Law Admission Test) - UG	
Conducting body	Consortium of National Law Universities; consortiumofnlus.ac.in
Used for	BA LLB (Hons) and other integrated law programmes at National Law Universities (including NLSIU Bengaluru) and many private law schools
Eligibility	Class 12 or equivalent (appearing candidates allowed); about 45% for General (40% SC/ST)†
Frequency / date	Once a year; CLAT 2027 expected 6 December 2026 (application deadline reported 31 October 2026); official notification not seen†
Pattern	120 MCQs, 2 hours, offline: English, Current Affairs / GK, Legal Reasoning, Logical Reasoning, Quantitative Techniques; +1 / -0.25. A committee may revise the pattern†

AILET (All India Law Entrance Test) - NLU Delhi	
Conducting body	National Law University, Delhi (NLU Delhi)
Used for	BA LLB (Hons) at NLU Delhi (separate from CLAT)
Eligibility	Passed or appearing in Class 12 or equivalent†
Frequency / date	AILET 2027 on 13 December 2026, 2 to 4 pm, offline; applications open until 10 November 2026; admit card due 30 November 2026
Pattern	150 MCQs: English Language 50, Current Affairs and GK 30, Logical Reasoning 70; no separate Legal Reasoning section; +1 / -0.25

SLAT (Symbiosis Law Admission Test) and other private-law tests	
Conducting body	Symbiosis International University; other private universities run their own tests
Frequency / date	SLAT reported for December 2026 in two slots; registrations opened in August 2026†
Pattern	60 MCQs, 60 minutes, 60 marks: English, Current Affairs and GK, Logical Reasoning, Legal Reasoning, Quantitative Aptitude†
LSAT India	Accepted by several private law schools; dates, eligibility and pattern not confirmed at the time of compilation†

Karnataka State Law University (KSLU) and affiliated colleges	
Programmes	5-year integrated BA LLB and BBA LLB (need 10+2); 3-year LLB (needs any graduation); LLM
Admission	Most sources say merit on qualifying marks with no entrance test; one source mentions a KSLU CET†
Timing	Application form expected April-July after PUC / degree results; dates not confirmed†

AIBE (All India Bar Examination) - Bar Council of India	
Conducting body	Bar Council of India (BCI); allindiabarexamination.com
Eligibility	Degree in law (3-year or 5-year LLB) from a BCI-recognised university; final-year students may register, with the enrolment certificate due after results†
Frequency / date	AIBE XXI held on 7 June 2026; AIBE XXII scheduled for 29 November 2026; BCI told the Supreme Court it would hold AIBE twice a year†
Pattern	Offline OMR, 3 hours 30 minutes, 100 MCQs, 1 mark each, no negative marking; open book (bare Acts allowed); syllabus now includes the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita and Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam
Passing	45 out of 100 for General and OBC; 40 for SC/ST
Result	Certificate of Practice, mandatory to practise law in India

Judicial services (Civil Judge exams)	
Conducting body	State Public Service Commissions with High Courts; in Karnataka, KPSC with the High Court†
Eligibility	LLB (3-year or 5-year) from a BCI-recognised university; minimum age about 21-22 and maximum 32-42 by state; practice requirement reported as 1 year (from April 2027 notifications) or 3 years after a May 2025 Supreme Court ruling, sources conflict†
Karnataka	No 2026 KPSC notification or age table found at the time of compilation†

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
CLAT-PG	Consortium of NLUs	LLM at National Law Universities	Once a year†
UGC-NET (Law)	NTA	Lectureship and research	Twice a year†
State judicial services exams	State PSCs	Civil Judge / Magistrate	Per state notification†

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
NLU and private law school scholarships	Universities and foundations	Merit and need based	Varies	Check each university†
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†

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Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†

Note: INSPIRE-SHE is for natural and basic sciences and does not apply to law students.†

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
BA LLB (Hons)	5 yr	CLAT, AILET, SLAT, college tests	Most common integrated degree
BBA LLB / BCom LLB	5 yr	CLAT, AILET, SLAT, college tests	Corporate and business law focus
LLB	3 yr	After any graduation; university or state tests	Route for graduates from any stream
LLM	1-2 yr	CLAT-PG and university tests	Specialisation: corporate, IP, constitutional, tax, environment, international
PhD in Law / Judicial services preparation	3+ yr	UGC-NET, university tests	Academic and judicial careers

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): NLSIU Bengaluru, NLU Delhi, NALSAR Hyderabad, NLIU Bhopal, WBNUJS Kolkata, Symbiosis Law School, Christ University School of Law, Jindal Global Law School, KSLU and affiliated colleges.†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Litigation	Advocate, senior counsel, public prosecutor, legal aid lawyer	Specialisation, Senior Advocate designation
Corporate and commercial law	Law firm associate, in-house counsel, compliance officer, M&A lawyer	LLM, MBA
Judiciary	Civil Judge, Magistrate, District Judge, Judge of the High Court (by seniority or direct recruitment)	Judicial services exams
Public sector and policy	Legal officer, law officer in government, policy researcher, legislative drafter	UPSC, LLM, public policy
Technology and IP	IP attorney, cyber-law specialist, data-privacy counsel	LLM in IP / technology law
Academia and media	Law professor, researcher, legal journalist, writer	LLM, PhD, UGC-NET

8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Commerce: BBA LLB / BCom LLB and corporate law connect directly (see Commerce document).
- Arts and Humanities: Political Science, History and Psychology feed legal reasoning and public policy (see Arts and Humanities document).
- Civil services and policy: law graduates commonly appear for UPSC; Law is also an optional subject.†
- Defence: law graduates can apply for Judge Advocate General (JAG) branches in the armed forces.†
- Technology: cyber law, data protection and IP overlap with Science and Engineering.

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ONE-PAGE GIST: Law

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-10	Build reading, English and reasoning; debate and quiz
After Class 10	Any stream; Humanities or Commerce is common; PUC in Karnataka
Class 11-12	Boards + CLAT, AILET, SLAT, LSAT India; read daily news
After Class 12	5-year BA LLB / BBA LLB (or 3-year LLB after any graduation)
After LLB	Enrol with State Bar Council; pass AIBE for Certificate of Practice
Career	Advocate, corporate counsel, judge, prosecutor, policy, academia; LLM / PhD

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
CLAT	December (2027: expected 6 Dec 2026)	120 MCQs, 2 hr; English, GK, Legal, Logical, Quant	+1 / -0.25
AILET	13 Dec 2026 (for 2027 intake)	150 Q, 2 hr: English 50, GK 30, Logical 70	+1 / -0.25
SLAT	December†	60 MCQs, 60 min	Check notification
AIBE	Twice a year (XXII: 29 Nov 2026)	100 MCQs, 3.5 hr, open book	No negative; pass 45 / 40
Civil Judge	Per state notification	Prelims, Mains, Interview	Check notification

Key rules: CLAT needs about 45% in Class 12 (40% SC/ST); LLB needs graduation; AIBE is mandatory to practise.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8), CSSS (UG), post-matric schemes via NSP / SSP, university scholarships.†

Careers: advocate, corporate lawyer, judge, public prosecutor, IP attorney, legal journalist, professor.

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LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Defence Services (Army, Navy, Air Force, Sainik Schools, Agniveer): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
School entry	Class 6 / 8 / 9	Sainik School (AISSEE) at Class 6 or 9; military school routes; join NCC in school	Early discipline, SSB-style training, entry to NDA later
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Stay fit; keep Maths and Science strong; NCC certificates	Agniveer (after Class 10), NDA / TES eligibility (PCM)
Entry after Class 10	After Class 10	Agniveer General Duty, Tradesman (age 17.5-21)	4-year service with chance of permanent enrolment
Entry after Class 12	After Class 12	NDA (3 services), 10+2 Technical Entry (Army TES), Navy 10+2 BTech Cadet Entry, Agniveer Technical / Clerk	Officer training with degree, or 4-year Agniveer service
Entry after graduation	After degree	CDS (IMA / INA / AFA / OTA), AFCAT, NCC Special Entry, technical graduate entries	Commissioned officer roles
Selection	All officer entries	Written test or JEE Main rank, then 5-day SSB interview and medical	Merit list and training academy seat
Career	Service years	Officer ranks, specialisation, second career after service	Command, technical, flying, legal and staff roles

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-10: School-level routes

- Sainik Schools: admission at Class 6 and Class 9 through AISSEE (NTA). Both boys and girls can appear; seats are reserved for SC, ST, OBC and wards of service personnel.
- Rashtriya Indian Military College (RIMC) takes students at Class 8; details not confirmed at the time of compilation.†
- NCC in school and college builds discipline and gives certificates (A, B, C) that help later entries; NCC "C" holders can use the NCC Special Entry route after graduation.†
- Fitness and Maths matter: all officer entries test physical standards and, for NDA / TES / Navy BTech, Physics and Maths.

After Class 10

- Agniveer (General Duty): Class 10 pass with minimum 45% and 33% in each subject (reported); Tradesman: Class 8 or 10 pass.
- Alternatively continue to Class 12: choose PCM for Air Force / Navy / Technical entries; any stream is allowed for NDA Army wing.

After Class 12

- NDA / NA: UPSC written test plus SSB; see detailed card below.
- Army 10+2 TES and Navy 10+2 BTech Cadet Entry: need PCM and a JEE Main score; selection by rank, then SSB.
- Agniveer Technical (Class 12 PCM + English), Clerk / Storekeeper Technical (60% any stream).

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After graduation

- CDS (UPSC) for IMA, INA, AFA, OTA; AFCAT for Air Force; NCC Special Entry; Territorial Army and technical graduate entries.†
- Law graduates may apply for JAG; engineers for technical branches.†

Selection and training

- SSB interview: five days at a Selection Board. Day 1 screening (OIR and picture perception test); Day 2 psychological tests; Days 3-4 Group Testing Officer tasks and interview; Day 5 conference. Centres include Bengaluru. Then medical examination.
- After selection: academy training (NDA Khadakwasla, IMA Dehradun, INA Ezhimala, AFA Dundigal, OTA Chennai†) and commissioning.

3. Early school-level exams and routes

Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
AISSEE (Sainik School entrance)	NTA	6 and 9 (boys and girls)	Offline OMR; 150 min (Class 6) and 180 min (Class 9)	2026 exam on 18 Jan 2026; next cycle registration expected Oct-Nov†
RIMC entrance	Rashtriya Indian Military College	8	Not confirmed at the time of compilation	†
NCC (school and college wings)	NCC Directorate	School and college	A, B, C certificates; camps and drills	Joined at school or college
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb

Tip for parents: for Sainik Schools, age and class rules are strict (Class 6: 10-12 years; Class 9: 13-15 years as on 31 March of the year, per the 2026 cycle). Check the NTA notice each year.

4. Entrance exams and selection

AISSEE (All India Sainik Schools Entrance Examination)	
Conducting body	National Testing Agency (NTA); exams.nta.ac.in
Eligibility	Class 6: age 10-12 on 31 March 2026, Class 5 passed. Class 9: age 13-15 on 31 March 2026 (born 1 Apr 2011 to 31 Mar 2013), Class 8 passed. Boys and girls for both classes (reported)
Pattern	Offline OMR; 150 minutes for Class 6 and 180 minutes for Class 9; section details not confirmed†
Reservation	Reported: 15% SC, 7.5% ST, 27% OBC, 25% wards of service personnel and ex-servicemen†
Frequency / date	Once a year; held 18 January 2026; application window and fee (about 850 for General) differ across sources†

NDA and NA (National Defence Academy / Naval Academy) - UPSC	
Conducting body	Union Public Service Commission (UPSC); upsc.gov.in
Eligibility	Class 12 pass (or appearing). Army wing: any stream. Air Force and Navy wings, and Naval Academy: Physics and Maths. Unmarried; about 16.5 to 19.5 years of age (birth-date window changes each cycle)†
Frequency / date	Twice a year (NDA I and NDA II); NDA II 2026 written exam was on 13 September 2026; next cycle notification expected around December†
Pattern	Written test 900 marks: Mathematics 300 and General Ability Test 600, 2.5 hours each; SSB interview 900 (total 1800); negative marking one-third†

CDS (Combined Defence Services) - UPSC	
Conducting body	UPSC; applications at upsconline.nic.in

Used for	Indian Military Academy (IMA), Indian Naval Academy (INA), Air Force Academy (AFA) and Officers Training Academy (OTA)
Eligibility	Unmarried graduates; INA and AFA need an engineering degree or BSc with Physics and Maths (reported; conflicting)†. Age about 19-24 (IMA / INA / AFA) and 19-25 (OTA); exact birth-date window set in each notification†
Frequency / dates	Twice a year. CDS I 2027: notification around 2-22 December 2026, exam 11 April 2027. CDS II 2027: notification about 12 May, exam 19 September 2027 (from UPSC calendar, subject to change)†
Pattern	IMA / INA / AFA: three papers (English, General Knowledge, Elementary Mathematics). OTA: two papers (English, General Knowledge)†. Then SSB, medical and merit

AFCAT (Air Force Common Admission Test)	
Conducting body	Indian Air Force; afcat.edcil.co.in
Eligibility	Flying branch: age 20-24 (up to 26 with commercial pilot licence); ground duty: 20-26 (as on 1 January of the cycle). Flying needs 50% in Maths and Physics at 10+2 and a graduation with 60%; technical branches need engineering degrees†
Frequency / dates	Twice a year. AFCAT 2 2026: applications 20 May - 19 June 2026, exam 8 August 2026. AFCAT 1 2027 notification not confirmed†
Pattern	Online, 100 questions in 120 minutes (General Awareness, Verbal Ability, Numerical Ability, Reasoning and Military Aptitude); negative marking; then AFSB and medical†

Agniveer (Agnipath scheme) - Army, Navy, Air Force	
Age and tenure	17.5 to 21 years; 4-year service including 6 months training; up to 25% of each batch may be retained permanently; about 11.71 lakh tax-free corpus at exit (reported)†
Education by post (reported)	General Duty: Class 10 with 45% and 33% in each subject. Technical: Class 12 with Physics, Chemistry, Maths and English, 50% overall and 40% in each. Clerk / Storekeeper Technical: 60% in Class 12, any stream. Tradesman: Class 8 or 10 pass. Navy and Air Force criteria differ and sources conflict†
Selection	Common Entrance Exam and physical / medical tests; pattern details not found at the time of compilation†

Indian Navy 10+2 BTech Cadet Entry	
Eligibility	70% combined in PCM and 50% in English (Class 10 or 12); must have appeared in JEE Main; unmarried. Jan 2027 batch: born 2 July 2007 to 1 January 2010; about 60 vacancies (reported)†
Selection	Shortlisting on JEE Main CRL rank, SSB interview, medical; BTech at Indian Naval Academy, Ezhimala
Timing	Applications for the Jan 2027 batch ran 29 May - 18 June 2026; next cycle expected mid-2027†

Indian Army 10+2 Technical Entry Scheme (TES)	
Eligibility	Class 12 with PCM, 60% aggregate; JEE Main score; unmarried male; TES-56 age 16.5 to 19.5. TES-57 (July 2027 course): applications reported 14 October to 12 November 2026†
Selection	Shortlisting on JEE Main rank, 5-day SSB, medical; four years of engineering training then commissioning

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
NCC Special Entry (Army)	Graduates with NCC "C" certificate	Graduation with at least 50% and NCC C with minimum B grade; direct SSB call†
Territorial Army and technical graduate entries	Working professionals and graduates	Schemes change yearly†
Coast Guard, CAPF (BSF, CRPF, CISF, ITBP) and state police	Uniformed services outside the three armed forces	Not covered at the time of compilation†

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
Staff college and service courses	Armed forces	Career progression	In service
CAPF (AC) exam	UPSC	Assistant Commandant in paramilitary forces	Once a year†
Defence PSU / DRDO / civilian roles	Various	After service or engineering degree	Per notification†

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
Scholarships for wards of ex-servicemen and Central Armed Police Forces	Ministry of Defence / Home Affairs, state boards	Wards of serving, retired and deceased personnel	Varies	Typically after Class 12 results†
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†

Note: officer cadets at NDA, IMA, INA and AFA receive free training, stipend and education during training.†

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
NDA: BSc / BTech at the academy then service academy	3 yr + 1 yr	NDA exam + SSB	Degree from JNU / affiliated; officer commission
Navy 10+2 BTech Cadet Entry	4 yr	JEE Main rank + SSB	BTech then commission in Navy
Army TES	4 yr + commission	JEE Main rank + SSB	Technical Entry Scheme
IMA / INA / AFA / OTA (after graduation)	1-1.5 yr	CDS + SSB	Commission as officer
Agniveer	4 yr	Agniveer entrance	Service then retention or exit corpus
Sainik School / Military School	Class 6-12	AISSEE / school-specific	Board education with military ethos

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Examples of institutions: National Defence Academy (Khadakwasla), Indian Military Academy (Dehradun), Indian Naval Academy (Ezhimala), Air Force Academy (Dundigal), Officers Training Academy (Chennai), Sainik Schools in Karnataka (for example Bijapur, Kodagu)†, RIMC (Dehradun).†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Army officer	Lieutenant to General; arms and services; technical corps	Staff college, defence services courses
Navy officer	Sub-Lieutenant to Admiral; executive, engineering, electrical, education branches	Naval staff and technical courses
Air Force officer	Flying, technical, ground duty branches; pilot	Staff and flying courses
Agniveer and JCO / OR	Soldier, sailor, airman; Junior Commissioned Officer after promotion	Retention, skill and second-career pathways
Defence support and legal	JAG officer, medical (AFMC), education, engineering corps	Specialised service courses
Second career	CAPF, police, corporate security, civil services, teaching, PSUs	Exams and resettlement courses

8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Science PCM: NDA Air Force / Navy, TES and Navy BTech need PCM (see Science PCM document).
- Science PCB: Armed Forces Medical Services through NEET and AFMC (see Science PCB document).
- Law: JAG branches for law graduates (see Law document).†
- Aviation and Maritime: pilot and merchant navy routes (see Hospitality, Aviation and Maritime document).
- Sports: sportspersons can enter through sports quotas in services.†
- Civil services: UPSC CAPF and CDS overlap with graduate career planning.

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ONE-PAGE GIST: Defence

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-10	Sainik School at Class 6 / 9 (AISSEE); NCC; fitness; keep Maths and Science strong
After Class 10	Agniveer (age 17.5-21) or continue Class 11-12 (PCM for technical entries)
After Class 12	NDA, Army TES / Navy BTech (JEE Main), Agniveer Technical / Clerk
After graduation	CDS, AFCAT, NCC Special Entry, technical graduate entries
Selection	Written test or JEE rank, then 5-day SSB and medical
Career	Officer, Agniveer / JCO, defence support roles, second career in CAPF / civil services

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
AISSEE	Jan (2026: 18 Jan)	Class 6 and 9; offline OMR; 150 / 180 min	Check notice
NDA	Twice a year (II: 13 Sep 2026)	Maths 300 + GAT 600; SSB 900	1/3 negative
CDS	Twice a year (I: 11 Apr 2027)	English, GK, Maths (OTA: 2 papers)	Check notification
AFCAT	Twice a year (2: 8 Aug 2026)	100 Q, 120 min online	Negative marking
Navy 10+2 / Army TES	Yearly; JEE Main based	70% PCM (Navy) / 60% PCM (Army)	JEE rank + SSB
Agniveer	Yearly notifications	Age 17.5-21; 4-year service	Entrance + physical

Key rules: officer entries are for unmarried candidates; Air Force / Navy / technical entries need Physics and Maths; every officer entry ends in the 5-day SSB.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8), CSSS (UG), wards-of-servicemen scholarships.†

Careers: Army / Navy / Air Force officer, Agniveer, JCO, JAG, defence medical, CAPF, civil services.

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LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Design and Architecture (Product, UX, Fashion, Architecture, Animation): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Draw, build, observe; try art, craft, model-making, digital tools	Portfolio habit; interest signals
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Keep an art / sketch book; keep Maths if architecture or design technology interests you	Keeps NATA (Maths) and B.Des options open
Stream choice	After Class 10	Any stream for B.Des; Physics + Maths (+ Chemistry / Biology / CS) for B.Arch; Maths for B.FTech	UCEED, NID DAT, NIFT, NATA, JEE Main Paper 2A eligibility
Preparation	Class 11-12	Drawing practice, design aptitude, visual and logical reasoning; build a portfolio	Entrance tests (UCEED, NID DAT, NIFT, NATA, private tests)
Degree	After Class 12	B.Des (4 yr), B.Arch (5 yr), B.FTech (4 yr), private design degrees	Studio training, internships
Postgraduate	4-5 years later	M.Des (CEED), M.Arch, M.Plan, MBA in design management	Specialist and leadership roles
Career	-	Product, UX / UI, communication, fashion, interior, architecture, animation, games	See section 7

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-10: Foundation

- Decision: draw, sketch, build models, photograph and observe. Try digital tools (drawing apps, simple 3D or coding).
- Start a portfolio: sketches, models, school projects and any art or craft. Portfolios matter for some institutes and interviews.†
- Keep Standard Maths in Class 10 (CBSE) if architecture or B.FTech is a possibility.†

After Class 10: Stream choice

- B.Des (UCEED, NID DAT, NIFT): any stream in Class 12 is eligible.
- B.Arch (NATA or JEE Main Paper 2A): Class 12 with Physics and Maths plus one more listed subject (Chemistry, Biology, Computer Science and others) with about 45% aggregate. Most colleges expect PCM.†
- B.FTech (NIFT): Maths needed in Class 12.
- Karnataka note: Class 11-12 is the 2-year Pre-University Course (PUC) after SSLC; CBSE/ICSE schools run Class 11-12 directly.

Class 11-12: Preparation

- Practise freehand drawing, composition, observation, visual reasoning and basic maths / logic. Prepare for the day-of-test pen-and-paper drawing.
- Many tests are held between October and June; register early because NID, UCEED and NIFT windows can close in the autumn and winter.

After Class 12: Degree

- B.Des at IITs, NID, NIFT, private universities; B.Arch at architecture colleges approved by the Council of Architecture; fashion, animation, game design and interior design at specialised institutes.

After the degree: Career

- Studio work, agencies, in-house design teams, start-ups, architecture practice (CoA registration), research, teaching and higher study.

3. Early preparation (Class 6-12)

Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
Art and design competitions, olympiads and workshops	Schools, NGOs, art institutes	6-12	Builds drawing and creativity; no formal entrance value	Through the year
NTSE	NCERT; Karnataka Stage 1 via DSERT	10	Not design-specific; covers Social Science and Mental Ability	2026-27 notification expected Aug-Oct†
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb

Tip for parents: design colleges look for curiosity and process, not only drawing skill. Keep a dated sketch book and photograph projects as a portfolio.

4. Entrance exams

UCEED (Undergraduate Common Entrance Exam for Design) - IIT Bombay	
Conducting body	IIT Bombay; uceed.iitb.ac.in
Used for	B.Des at IIT Bombay, IIT Delhi, IIT Guwahati, IIT Hyderabad, IIT Roorkee, IIT Indore and IIITDM Jabalpur; many other institutes accept scores†
Eligibility	Any stream. Class 12 (or equivalent) appeared for the first time in 2026 or 2027. Born on or after 1 Oct 2002 (1 Oct 1997 for SC/ST/PwD)†
Frequency / dates	Once a year; UCEED 2027 reported for 17 January 2027; registration reported 1-31 October 2026 (one source gives 21 October)†
Pattern (previous year pattern)	Part A: computer-based, 2 hours, 200 marks (numerical answers, multiple select and multiple choice; partial negative marking for MCQ / MSQ; no negative marking for numerical). Part B: pen-and-paper drawing, 1 hour, 100 marks, checked only if Part A cutoff is cleared. Total 300†

NID DAT (Design Aptitude Test) - National Institute of Design	
Conducting body	National Institute of Design (NID); admissions.nid.edu
Used for	B.Des at NID campuses (including Bengaluru)†
Eligibility	10+2 in any stream; Maths recommended; no upper age limit; General and EWS candidates born on or after 1 July 2006 (one source)†
Frequency / dates	Once a year; applications reported 10 Sep - 30 Nov 2026; DAT Prelims 20 December 2026; final Class 12 marksheet by 15 July 2027†
Pattern	Prelims, then Mains with studio tests and interview. Prelims structure not confirmed at the time of compilation†

NIFT (National Institute of Fashion Technology)	
Conducting body	NIFT with NTA; nift.ac.in
Eligibility	B.Des: Class 12 in any stream. B.FTech: Mathematics required (Physics and Maths per one source). UG age: under 24 on 1 Aug 2027 (5-year relaxation SC/ST/PwD)†

Pattern	GAT (General Ability Test) and CAT (Creative Ability Test), then Situation Test / interview for some courses†
Frequency / dates	Once a year; 2027 dates not yet published†

NATA (National Aptitude Test in Architecture)	
Conducting body	Council of Architecture (CoA); nata.in
Used for	B.Arch admissions (JEE Main Paper 2A is the alternative)
Eligibility	Passed or appearing in Class 12 with Physics and Maths, or a 10+3 diploma with Maths; about 45% aggregate (one source says 50%); college rules often higher†
Frequency / dates	Multiple sessions in one academic year, best score counts. 2026 window 4 April - 13 June (Fri / Sat); attempts reported as two or three†
Pattern	3 hours, 200 marks: Part A drawing and composition (80, offline) and Part B aptitude (120, online); no negative marking reported†

JEE Main Paper 2A (B.Arch) and 2B (B.Planning)	
Conducting body	NTA; jeemain.nta.nic.in
Pattern	400 marks each (reported); see Science PCM document for JEE Main details†
Used for	B.Arch / B.Planning at NITs and other participating institutes via JoSAA†

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
KCET (with NATA) for B.Arch in Karnataka	B.Arch seats in Karnataka colleges	Combines NATA and board / KCET marks per KEA rules†
Private design institutes (Srishti, MIT Institute of Design, Pearl Academy, Symbiosis SID, Anant, others)	B.Des, fashion, animation, interior	Own entrance tests and portfolio rounds; dates and fees vary†
CUET-UG	BA / BFA at central universities	50 MCQs per subject, 60 min, +5 / -1; see Science documents†
Animation, game design, interior design, UX diplomas	Short and long courses after Class 12	Industry-linked institutes; quality varies, check recognition†

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
CEED (Common Entrance Exam for Design)	IIT Bombay	M.Des and PhD at IITs and others	January (with UCEED)†
GATE (Architecture and Planning)	IIT-organised	M.Arch, M.Plan	Feb†
NID M.Des / NIFT M.Des / MFM	NID / NIFT	Postgraduate design and fashion	Yearly†
CoA registration	Council of Architecture	Practise as an architect after B.Arch	After degree†

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
Institute scholarships (IITs, NID, NIFT, private universities)	Institutes and foundations	Merit and need based	Varies	Check each institute†

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†

Note: INSPIRE-SHE is for natural and basic sciences and does not apply to design students.†

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
B.Des (Product, Communication, Interaction, Textile, Fashion, Animation, Interior)	4 yr	UCEED, NID DAT, NIFT, private tests	Studio-based degree
B.Arch	5 yr	NATA or JEE Main Paper 2A	CoA-approved; registration to practise
B.FTech	4 yr	NIFT with Maths	Fashion technology
B.Planning	4 yr	JEE Main Paper 2B and others	Urban and regional planning
BFA / BA Design / Animation	3-4 yr	College tests, CUET	Fine arts, visual communication
M.Des / M.Arch / M.Plan	2 yr	CEED, GATE, college tests	Specialisation and research

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): IIT Bombay (IDC), IIT Delhi, IIT Guwahati, IIT Hyderabad, NID (including Bengaluru), NIFT (including Bengaluru), Srishti Manipal Institute, MIT Institute of Design, RV College of Architecture, BMS School of Architecture, CEPT University.†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Product and industrial design	Product designer, design engineer, CMF designer, design researcher	M.Des, design management
UX / UI and interaction	UX designer, UI designer, service designer, UX researcher	M.Des in interaction, HCI
Communication and graphic design	Graphic designer, brand designer, art director, illustrator	M.Des, creative leadership
Fashion and textile	Fashion designer, merchandiser, stylist, textile designer	M.Des, MFM, retail management
Architecture and planning	Architect, urban planner, landscape and interior architect	M.Arch, M.Plan, CoA registration
Animation, games and media	Animator, VFX artist, game designer, motion designer	Specialised courses

8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Science PCM: B.Arch and B.FTech need Physics and Maths (see Science PCM document).
- Arts and Humanities: B.Des and BFA are open to all streams (see Arts and Humanities document).
- Commerce: brand, marketing and retail design combine with management (see Commerce document).

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- Technology: UX, game design and design engineering sit between design and computer science.
- Entrepreneurship and skills: freelance design and studios (see Skills and Entrepreneurship document).

ONE-PAGE GIST: Design and Architecture

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-10	Sketch book, models, digital tools; keep Standard Maths if architecture is possible
After Class 10	Any stream for B.Des; PCM-based for B.Arch / B.FTech; PUC in Karnataka
Class 11-12	Boards + drawing and aptitude practice; UCEED, NID DAT, NIFT, NATA
After Class 12	B.Des (4 yr), B.Arch (5 yr), B.FTech, BFA, animation and interior courses
Postgraduate	M.Des (CEED), M.Arch, M.Plan, design management
Career	Product, UX, communication, fashion, architect, animation, interiors

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
UCEED	January (2027: 17 Jan)	Part A 200 + Part B drawing 100; any stream	Check brochure
NID DAT	Prelims 20 Dec 2026†	Prelims then Mains / studio; any stream	Check brochure
NIFT	Yearly†	GAT + CAT (+ situation test); B.FTech needs Maths	Check notification
NATA	Apr-Jun sessions	3 hr, 200 marks: drawing 80 + aptitude 120	No negative reported
JEE Main Paper 2A	Jan and Apr	B.Arch via NITs; 400 marks	Check bulletin

Key rules: B.Des accepts all streams; B.Arch needs Physics + Maths (about 45%); build a portfolio from Class 8.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8), CSSS (UG), institute scholarships.†

Careers: designer (product, UX, graphic, fashion), architect, planner, animator, interior designer.

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LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Hospitality, Aviation and Maritime (Hotels, Pilot, Cabin Crew, Merchant Navy): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Build English, communication, geography and teamwork; explore travel and service interests	Language and soft skills used in all three fields
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Keep Maths and Science strong for pilot, aircraft maintenance and marine engineering	Keeps PCM-based options open
Stream choice	After Class 10	Hospitality: any stream with English. Pilot / AME / Marine: PCM. Cabin crew: any stream	NCHM JEE, IGRUA, AME CET, IMU CET eligibility
Preparation	Class 11-12	Boards + NCHM JEE, IMU CET, flying school tests; fitness and medical readiness	Seats in hotel management, flying, maritime programmes
Degree / training	After Class 12	BSc Hospitality, CPL pilot training, AME, cabin crew courses, BSc Nautical Science, BTech Marine	Industry licences and sea or flying time
Career	After training	Hotels and tourism, airlines and airports, shipping and ports	See section 7

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-10: Foundation

- Decision: build English, Hindi, communication, geography and teamwork. Try scouts, NCC, sports, school hospitality or travel clubs.
- For pilot, aircraft engineer and marine roles: keep Physics, Maths and fitness strong; medical and eyesight standards are strict.†

After Class 10: Stream choice

- Hospitality (NCHM JEE): Class 12 in any stream with English.
- Pilot (CPL): Physics and Maths in Class 12 is the long-standing rule; DGCA was reported to remove the requirement for Commerce and Arts students if they complete a bridge course, but sources conflict on whether this is notified.†
- Aircraft Maintenance Engineer (AME): Class 12 PCM or an engineering diploma after Class 10; AME CET for entry to approved colleges.†
- Marine (IMU CET): PCM with minimum marks in English.
- Karnataka note: Class 11-12 is the 2-year Pre-University Course (PUC) after SSLC; CBSE/ICSE schools run Class 11-12 directly.

Class 11-12: Preparation

- Hospitality: apply to NCHM JEE (April), then counselling in May-June; or apply directly to private hotel management schools.
- Pilot: apply to flying schools and IGRUA (entrance around May); start medical checks early (DGCA Class 1 medical).†
- Maritime: IMU CET (May) after Class 12; medical and eyesight checks are important.

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After Class 12: Training

- BSc Hospitality and Hotel Administration (3 yr), BHM (4 yr), culinary and tourism courses.
- CPL ground exams and flying hours; or integrated pilot programmes at flying academies.
- BSc Nautical Science, BTech Marine Engineering, other IMU courses; DG Shipping approved courses.

Career

- Hotels, resorts, cruise lines, airlines, airports, ships and ports, tourism and events; supervisory and management growth with experience.

3. Early preparation (Class 6-12)

Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
Scouts, NCC, sports, school clubs	Schools and NCC Directorate	6-12	Teamwork, discipline and fitness	Through the year
English and communication competitions	Schools and NGOs	6-12	Builds service and customer skills	Through the year
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb

Tip for parents: pilot and marine careers have strict medical, eyesight and physical standards. Check these requirements early with the training institute.

4. Entrance exams and licences

NCHM JEE (Hotel Management) - NTA	
Conducting body	NTA for the National Council for Hotel Management; exams.nta.nic.in/nchm-jee
Used for	BSc in Hospitality and Hotel Administration at NCHM-affiliated Institutes of Hotel Management (IHM), including IHM Bangalore
Eligibility	10+2 with English; no age limit; appearing candidates can apply; no stream restriction stated (inferred)†
Frequency / dates	Once a year; 2026 exam on 25 April (CBT, 120 cities); registration extended to 1 April; counselling around 31 May - 3 June†
Pattern	Computer-based; duration reported as 3 hours, though one source gives 11 am - 1 pm; section-wise breakdown not confirmed†

Hotel management in Bengaluru (examples)	
IHM Bangalore	BSc Hospitality and Hotel Administration, 3 years (6 semesters); about 285 seats (reported); entry via NCHM JEE counselling; fees reported between about 3.7 lakh and 7.2 lakh total, sources conflict†
MS Ramaiah College of Hotel Management	Four-year BHM; 45% in Class 12 and valid RUAS AT or CUET-UG marks (reported); about 1.79 lakh per year†
IIHM Bangalore	Three-year BA with the University of West London via the e-CHAT test (reported)†

Pilot: CPL, IGRUA and flying schools	
Licence	Commercial Pilot Licence (CPL) from DGCA after ground exams and flying hours; Class 1 medical; minimum age 18 (standard)†
Eligibility	IGRUA prospectus: 10+2 with Physics, Maths and English, 50% aggregate; another IGRUA page says 50% in each of English, Physics and Maths (45% for SC/ST/OBC/EWS). Sources conflict†
DGCA rule change	Reports from May 2025: Physics and Maths no longer required for Commerce and Arts students who complete an approved NIOS bridge course; another report says only proposed†

IGRUA entrance	Indira Gandhi Rashtriya Uran Akademi, Amethi; 2026 entrance on 3 May 2026 (applications until 13 April); application fee 10,000 or 12,000 by source†
Cost and time	CPL training cost and duration not confirmed at the time of compilation†

Cabin crew, airport ground staff and AME	
Cabin crew	Class 12 pass; fluent English and Hindi (and often a local language); minimum height about 155 cm (reported); age bands vary 18-32 or 19-35 by airline†
Airport ground staff	Class 12 pass; English and Hindi; minimum age 18-20 depending on employer†
Aircraft Maintenance Engineer (AME)	Class 12 PCM or engineering diploma after Class 10; AME CET; DGCA CAR 147 approved organisations†

IMU CET (Indian Maritime University Common Entrance Test)	
Conducting body	Indian Maritime University (IMU); imu.edu.in
Used for	BTech Marine Engineering, BSc Nautical Science, and other maritime courses
Eligibility	10+2 with 60% aggregate in Physics, Chemistry and Maths and 50% in English in Class 10 and 12 (reported); age limits and Nautical Science specifics not confirmed†
Frequency / dates	Once a year; 2026 exam on 24 May 2026 (CBT); application deadline reported as 24 or 28 April 2026†
Pattern	BTech paper reported as 200 MCQs across Physics, Chemistry, Maths, English and General Aptitude, about 3 hours†

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
DG Shipping approved courses and sponsorships	Deck and engine officer cadets	Approved pre-sea training, company sponsorship, sea time†
GP Rating and other post-Class 10 maritime courses	After Class 10	Not researched at the time of compilation†
Aerospace Engineering (BTech)	After Class 12 PCM	See Science PCM document; JEE Main / KCET
Tourism, travel and events degrees	After Class 12	University or private institute tests†

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
ATPL and instructor ratings	DGCA / flying schools	Airline captain and instructor roles	After CPL and hours†
IMU PG and Master Mariner exams	IMU / DG Shipping	Senior sea and shore roles	After sea time†
MBA in Hospitality / Aviation / Shipping	IIMs and others	Management roles	CAT and university tests†

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
Sponsorship and bank loan schemes for pilot and maritime training	Banks, companies, shipping lines	Selected cadets	Varies	Per programme†

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Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†

Note: pilot and maritime training can be expensive; check loan, sponsorship and scholarship options before enrolling.†

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
BSc Hospitality and Hotel Administration	3 yr	NCHM JEE	Hotels, airlines, cruise, events
BHM / BA Hospitality (private)	3-4 yr	College tests, CUET, RUAS AT	Management track
CPL pilot programmes	1.5-3 yr	Flying school / IGRUA entrance	DGCA CPL; medical Class 1
AME / Aerospace diploma / BTech	3-4 yr	AME CET, JEE, KCET	Aircraft maintenance and engineering
Cabin crew and ground handling courses	6 months - 1 yr	Institute interviews and airline recruitment	English and personality skills
BSc Nautical Science / BTech Marine Engineering	3-4 yr	IMU CET	DG Shipping approved

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): IHM Bangalore, MS Ramaiah College of Hotel Management, IGRUA (Amethi), Indian Maritime University campuses, DGCA-approved flying clubs, AME colleges.†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Hospitality	Hotel manager, chef, front office, F&B, event manager, cruise hospitality	MBA Hospitality, culinary specialisation
Aviation (flying)	Commercial pilot, first officer, captain, flight instructor	ATPL, type ratings
Aviation (ground and cabin)	Cabin crew, airport ground staff, ticketing, customer service	Supervisory roles, airline management
Aircraft engineering	Aircraft maintenance engineer, avionics technician	DGCA licences, BTech Aerospace
Maritime	Deck officer, engineer officer, ship manager, port and shipping logistics	Master Mariner, MBA Shipping

8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Science PCM: pilot, AME and marine engineering need PCM (see Science PCM document).
- Defence: Navy and Air Force careers overlap with merchant navy and aviation (see Defence document).
- Commerce and Management: hotel, airline and shipping management roles (see Commerce document).
- Skills and Entrepreneurship: restaurants, travel start-ups and events (see Skills and Entrepreneurship document).

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ONE-PAGE GIST: Hospitality, Aviation and Maritime

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-10	Build English, teamwork, fitness; keep Maths and Science strong for pilot and marine
After Class 10	Hospitality: any stream with English. Pilot / AME / Marine: PCM; PUC in Karnataka
Class 11-12	Boards + NCHM JEE, IGRUA / flying school tests, IMU CET; medicals
After Class 12	BSc Hospitality; CPL pilot; AME; cabin crew; BSc Nautical / BTech Marine
Training	Industry licences, flying hours, sea time, internships
Career	Hotel manager, pilot, cabin crew, AME, deck / engine officer, port and shipping roles

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
NCHM JEE	April (2026: 25 Apr)	CBT; 10+2 with English; BSc HHA at IHMs	Check bulletin
IGRUA entrance	May (2026: 3 May)	10+2 PCM-English, 50%; pilot training	Check prospectus
IMU CET	May (2026: 24 May)	CBT; 60% PCM + 50% English; marine courses	Check notification
AME CET	Yearly†	PCM or diploma; DGCA-approved colleges	Check notification
Cabin crew	Airline recruitment	Class 12, English / Hindi, height about 155 cm	Interview-based

Key rules: pilot and marine need Physics, Maths and strict medicals; hotel management accepts all streams.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8), CSSS (UG), loans and sponsorships for pilot / marine.†

Careers: hotel manager, chef, pilot, cabin crew, aircraft engineer, merchant navy officer.

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LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Health and Allied Sciences (Nursing, Pharmacy, Allied Health, AYUSH): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Build Science curiosity, empathy and communication; try first aid, Red Cross / Scouts, health clubs	Biology interest and service attitude
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Keep Biology and Chemistry strong; basic Maths is enough for most health courses	PCB stream in Class 11-12
Stream choice	After Class 10	Choose PCB (Physics, Chemistry, Biology) in Class 11-12 (PUC in Karnataka)	Eligibility for nursing, pharmacy, allied health, AYUSH, veterinary
Preparation	Class 11-12	Boards + NEET-UG (AYUSH, allied health) and KCET (nursing, pharmacy in Karnataka)	Merit seats via counselling
Degree	After Class 12	BSc Nursing, B.Pharm / Pharm.D, BPT, BSc MLT / Radiology / Optometry, BAMS / BHMS / BUMS / BNYS	Professional licence after council registration
Registration	After degree	Register with the relevant council (State Nursing Council, Pharmacy Council, NCAHP bodies, CCIM / CCH)	Right to practise
Postgraduate	2-4 years later	MSc Nursing, M.Pharm, MPT, MD (AYUSH), public health, hospital administration	Specialist, teaching and research roles

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-10: Foundation

- Decision: learn first aid, hygiene and health basics; join Red Cross, Scouts / Guides or school health clubs.
- Keep Biology and Chemistry strong; for B.Pharm (PCM route) keep Maths as well.

After Class 10: Stream choice

- Choose PCB. Add Maths if you want pharmacy via the PCM route or a keep-both-doors approach (PCMB).
- Karnataka note: Class 11-12 is the 2-year Pre-University Course (PUC) after SSLC; CBSE/ICSE schools run Class 11-12 directly.

Class 11-12: Preparation

- Prepare for NEET-UG (AYUSH, allied health, veterinary) and KCET (BSc Nursing and B.Pharm in Karnataka) together; boards still matter for the PCB percentage rule.
- Check age rules: minimum 17 years on 31 December of the admission year is quoted for nursing and AYUSH.

After Class 12: Degree

- BSc Nursing (4 yr); B.Pharm (4 yr); Pharm.D (6 yr); BPT (4.5 yr); BSc MLT, Radiology, Optometry (3-4 yr); BAMS / BHMS / BUMS / BSMS / BNYS (5.5 yr including internship).

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- Counselling: KEA (Karnataka) for KCET seats and state AYUSH / NEET seats; AACCC for all-India AYUSH seats; deemed universities run their own processes.

After the degree: Registration and career

- Register with the relevant council; join hospitals, pharma companies, diagnostics, public health, research or start a practice or clinic.

3. Early preparation (Class 6-12)

Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
Red Cross / Scouts / first-aid and health clubs	Schools and NGOs	6-12	Service attitude and basic skills	Through the year
NSO / science olympiads	SOF and others	1-12	Biology and Science practice†	See Science PCB document
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb

Tip for parents: health careers need steady Biology and Chemistry marks and often a minimum PCB percentage (commonly 45%-50% General). Keep board marks healthy alongside entrance prep.

4. Entrance exams and counselling

BSc Nursing - Karnataka route	
Counselling body	KEA (via KCET) for government and most private RGUHS-affiliated colleges; RGUHS follows INC norms
Eligibility	10+2 with Physics, Chemistry and Biology; 45% aggregate in PCB for General, 40% for SC/ST (OBC per some listings); age 17 years on 31 December of the admission year†
Entrance	KCET (Karnataka); a government order of April 2023 is cited for KCET. NEET is reported as not required for Karnataka nursing; deemed universities (Manipal, Yenepoya) run their own tests. 2026 KCET was 23-24 April†
Outside Karnataka	AIIMS and some national institutes use NEET or their own tests†

B.Pharm, Pharm.D and D.Pharm	
Counselling body	KEA via KCET for government, aided and many private seats; private management quotas vary
Eligibility	B.Pharm: 10+2 with Physics, Chemistry and Biology or Maths; 45% General / 40% reserved per PCI norms (one source says 50%). Pharm.D: PCB / PCM or D.Pharm for lateral entry to 4th year. D.Pharm: 2-year diploma after PCB / PCM†
Entrance	KCET; NEET is not required; BITSAT also accepted at BITS for B.Pharm†
Postgraduate	M.Pharm via GPAT or state rules; GPAT details not confirmed†

Allied Health Sciences (BPT, BSc MLT, Radiology, Optometry and others)	
Regulator	National Commission for Allied and Healthcare Professions (NCAHP); 13 curricula notified so far (reported)
NEET rule	NCAHP reportedly told institutions that NEET is a basic eligibility criterion for allied and healthcare UG courses from 2026-27; Karnataka-specific rules are not confirmed†
Eligibility	10+2 with PCB (some courses accept PCM); minimum percentages per curriculum†

AYUSH (BAMS, BHMS, BUMS, BSMS, BNYS)	
Entrance	NEET-UG; only NEET-qualified candidates can join AYUSH counselling

Counselling	AACCC (aaccc.gov.in) for 15% all-India quota in government colleges, central universities, institutes and deemed universities; state counselling for 85% state quota (Karnataka: KEA†)
Eligibility	PCB; NEET percentile cutoff 50th for General / EWS and 40th for SC/ST/OBC; age 17 years by 31 December 2026†
Seats	About 52,720 seats in 914 colleges across BAMS, BUMS, BHMS, BSMS and BNYS (reported)†

NEET-UG (reference)	
Details	Full NEET-UG rules, pattern and 2026 re-exam notes are in the Science PCB document

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
Public health, nutrition and dietetics, speech and audiology, occupational therapy, prosthetics	Allied and rehabilitation fields	Regulated by NCAHP or RCI; entry rules differ†
Clinical psychology and counselling	Mental health	RCI registration; see Arts and Humanities document†
Emergency medical technician, paramedic, nursing assistant (certificate / diploma)	Short-course health roles	Approved institutions; entry after Class 10 or 12†

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
NEET-PG / NEET-MDS	NBEMS	MD / MS / MDS after MBBS / BDS	Once a year†
GPAT	NTA	M.Pharm	Once a year†
MSc Nursing, MPT and AYUSH PG entrance	Universities and AIAPGET	Postgraduate health courses	Varies†
CSIR-UGC NET / ICMR JRF	NTA / ICMR	Research	See Science PCB document†

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
Health-sciences scholarships (state, institute, CSR)	State departments, colleges, foundations	Merit and need based	Varies	Check each provider†
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†

Note: INSPIRE-SHE is for natural and basic sciences and does not apply to professional health degrees.†

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
BSc Nursing	4 yr	KCET (Karnataka)	Hospital and community nursing; State Nursing Council registration
B.Pharm / Pharm.D	4 yr / 6 yr	KCET	Pharmacy Council registration
BPT (Physiotherapy)	4.5 yr	NEET or state route†	NCAHP-regulated
BSc MLT / Radiology / Optometry / OT / Perfusion	3-4 yr	NEET or university entry†	Diagnostics and technician roles
BAMS / BHMS / BUMS / BSMS / BNYS	4.5 yr + 1 yr internship	NEET-UG + AYUSH counselling	AYUSH practice; CCIM / CCH registration
MBBS / BDS	5-5.5 yr	NEET-UG	See Science PCB document

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): St John's College of Nursing, MS Ramaiah Institute of Nursing, Manipal and Yenepoya universities, Government College of Pharmacy Bengaluru, RGUHS-affiliated colleges, AIIMS institutes, central AYUSH institutes.†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Nursing	Staff nurse, ICU / OT nurse, community health nurse, nurse educator, military nursing	MSc Nursing, PhD, specialisations
Pharmacy	Hospital pharmacist, clinical pharmacist, regulatory affairs, pharma sales and research	M.Pharm, MBA, PhD
Allied health	Physiotherapist, lab technologist, radiographer, optometrist, OT technician	MPT, MSc, specialisation
AYUSH	Ayurvedic, homeopathic, unani physician; wellness and yoga therapist	MD (AYUSH), research
Public health and administration	Public health officer, hospital administrator, health-tech roles	MPH, MBA Healthcare

8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Science PCB: MBBS, BDS, veterinary and biology research (see Science PCB document).
- Agriculture and Veterinary: BVSc and allied animal-health careers (see Agriculture document).
- Arts and Humanities: psychology and counselling (see Arts and Humanities document).
- Defence: Armed Forces Medical Services and Military Nursing Service (see Defence document).
- Sports: sports medicine, physiotherapy and sports science (see Sports and Arts document).

ONE-PAGE GIST: Health and Allied Sciences

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-10	First aid, health clubs; keep Biology and Chemistry strong
After Class 10	Choose PCB; PUC in Karnataka
Class 11-12	Boards + NEET-UG and KCET; check PCB percentage rule
After Class 12	BSc Nursing, B.Pharm, BPT, BSc MLT / Radiology, BAMS / BHMS / BUMS
Registration	Register with State Nursing / Pharmacy / allied or AYUSH council
Career	Nurse, pharmacist, therapist, technologist, AYUSH doctor, public health

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
KCET (Karnataka)	April (2026: 23-24)	BSc Nursing and B.Pharm via KEA counselling	No negative
NEET-UG	May (2026 re-exam: 21 Jun)	AYUSH, allied health (reported), veterinary; 180 Q, 720 marks	+4 / -1
AYUSH counselling	After NEET results	AACCC (15% AIQ) + state counselling (85%)	Percentile cutoff 50 / 40
Allied health	From 2026-27†	NEET reported mandatory; check NCAHP curriculum	Check notification

Key rules: nursing needs 45% PCB (General) and age 17 by 31 Dec; AYUSH needs NEET; allied health is moving to NEET.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8), CSSS (UG), post-matric schemes via NSP / SSP.†

Careers: nurse, pharmacist, physiotherapist, lab technologist, radiographer, Ayurvedic / homeopathic doctor, public health officer.

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LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Agriculture, Veterinary and Forestry (Agri-science, Horticulture, Animal Health, Forests): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Observe plants, soil, animals and weather; try gardening, school farm or nature clubs	Interest in life sciences and the environment
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Keep Science strong; join eco-clubs and Agri / Environment projects	PCB or PCMB in Class 11-12
Stream choice	After Class 10	Choose PCB or PCMB (Physics, Chemistry, Biology / Maths) in Class 11-12 (PUC in Karnataka)	Eligibility for KCET agri seats, ICAR via CUET, NEET (veterinary)
Preparation	Class 11-12	Boards + KCET (Karnataka agri / horticulture / forestry), CUET-UG (ICAR 15% quota), NEET-UG (BVSc)	Seats at agricultural, horticultural, veterinary and forestry colleges
Degree	After Class 12	BSc (Hons) Agriculture / Horticulture / Forestry, BFSc, BVSc & AH, Agri-business and allied degrees	Professional and research careers
Postgraduate	2-3 years later	MSc Agri, MVSc, MBA Agri-business, PhD, ICAR-JRF	Scientist, officer and entrepreneur roles
Career	-	Agri-officer, scientist, veterinarian, forest officer, agri-entrepreneur	See section 7

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-10: Foundation

- Decision: start a garden, compost or nature club; observe plants and animals; read about farming and environment.
- Science and Biology interest is the base for later entrance exams.

After Class 10: Stream choice

- PCB or PCMB works for agriculture, horticulture, forestry and fisheries; veterinary needs PCB (NEET).
- Karnataka note: Class 11-12 is the 2-year Pre-University Course (PUC) after SSLC; CBSE/ICSE schools run Class 11-12 directly.

Class 11-12: Preparation

- For agricultural universities in Karnataka (UAS Bangalore, UAS Dharwad, UHS Bagalkot, KSNUAHS Shivamogga): KCET (PCMB) with KEA counselling for the state quota, and CUET-UG (ICAR) for the 15% all-India quota.†
- For veterinary (BVSc & AH): NEET-UG merit, per the Veterinary Council of India.

After Class 12: Degree

- BSc (Hons) Agriculture, Horticulture, Forestry, Sericulture, Fisheries (BFSc), Agri-business Management, Food Technology; BVSc & AH for veterinary.

After the degree: Career

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- Government and bank agri-officer posts, ICAR and state research, seed and agri-input companies, forest services (state and IFoS), veterinary practice, dairy and fisheries, farming and agri-start-ups.

3. Early preparation (Class 6-12)

Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
Eco-clubs, nature camps, school gardens	Schools, forest departments, NGOs	6-12	Builds interest and observation	Through the year
Science olympiads / NSO	SOF and others	1-12	Biology and Science practice†	See Science PCB document
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb

Tip for parents: agriculture and veterinary are science-based professions. Keep PCB marks healthy and visit a farm, nursery or veterinary clinic with your child.

4. Entrance exams and services

ICAR UG admission via CUET-UG	
Conducting body	NTA for ICAR (all-India quota); counselling at icarcounseling.com†
Used for	15% all-India quota seats in about 13 UG programmes (including BSc (Hons) Agriculture) across about 74 ICAR-accredited agricultural universities; this replaced the stand-alone AIEEA UG
Eligibility	Class 12 with required subjects (PCB / PCM / Agriculture combinations); each university sets details†
Pattern	CUET-UG; 50 MCQs per domain subject, 60 minutes, +5 / -1 (see Science documents)
Timing	CUET May-June; ICAR counselling July-September†

KCET - Karnataka agriculture, horticulture and forestry	
Counselling body	Karnataka Examinations Authority (KEA); universities: UAS Bangalore (GKVK), UAS Dharwad, UHS Bagalkot, KSNUAHS Shivamogga
Rule	State quota (85%) via KCET + KEA counselling; merit uses KCET marks with qualifying PCMB marks; 15% via ICAR (CUET). KCET 2026: 23-24 April, results 6 June†
Forestry	BSc Forestry at colleges in Sirsi and Ponnampet; sources conflict on the parent university (Shivamogga vs Dharwad)†

BVSc & AH (Veterinary) via NEET-UG	
Rule	Veterinary Council of India: admission on NEET-UG merit rank, no other weightage; 15% all-India quota by VCI counselling; state quotas follow
Eligibility	10+2 with Physics, Chemistry, Biology / Biotechnology; minimum 50% aggregate (47.5% for SC/ST and special categories)†
Duration	About 5 years including internship†

Indian Forest Service (IFoS) and forest services	
Conducting body	UPSC (IFoS); state forest departments recruit Range Forest Officers
Eligibility	Bachelor's degree including one of Animal Husbandry and Veterinary Science, Botany, Chemistry, Geology, Mathematics, Physics, Statistics or Zoology, or a degree in Agriculture, Forestry or Engineering; age 21-32 as on 1 August (relaxations vary); attempts General 6, OBC 9, SC/ST unlimited†

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Note	IFoS prelims is the same as the Civil Services prelims; mains is separate†

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
Fisheries (BFSc), Dairy Technology, Sericulture, Food Technology, Agri-business Management	Allied agri fields	Entry through KCET / CUET / university tests; Karnataka BFSc details not found†
Agricultural Diploma / Polytechnic	After Class 10	See Polytechnic and ITI document†
Agri-entrepreneurship, farming, organic and precision agriculture	Self-employment	Training via KVKs, universities and start-ups†

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
ICAR AIEEA PG / CUET-PG	NTA / ICAR	MSc Agri, MVSc	Once a year†
ICAR-JRF / SRF	ICAR	PhD funding	Once a year†
UPSC IFoS / UPSC CSE, state PSC and agri-officer exams	UPSC / states	Services	Yearly†
NABARD, banks and agri-business MBA tests	Various	Rural banking and agri-business	Yearly†

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
ICAR and university scholarships; state agricultural university scholarships	ICAR, universities	Merit and need based	Varies	Check each university†
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†

Note: INSPIRE-SHE is for natural and basic sciences; some agriculture-science degrees may qualify.†

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
BSc (Hons) Agriculture	4 yr	KCET (state) / CUET-ICAR (15%)	Largest agri degree
BSc (Hons) Horticulture	4 yr	KCET / CUET-ICAR	UHS Bagalkot and others
BSc (Hons) Forestry	4 yr	KCET / CUET-ICAR	Sirsi, Ponnampet; forest services
BFSc (Fisheries)	4 yr	State / ICAR route†	Aquaculture and fisheries

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Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
BVSc & AH	About 5 yr	NEET-UG	Veterinary practice; VCI registration
BTech Agricultural Engineering / Food Technology	4 yr	KCET / JEE / CUET†	Engineering in agri sector

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): UAS Bangalore (GKVK), UAS Dharwad, UHS Bagalkot, KSNUAHS Shivamogga, College of Forestry Sirsi and Ponnampet, KVAFSU Bidar (veterinary, fisheries)†, ICAR institutes (IARI, IVRI).†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Agriculture and horticulture	Agri-officer, agronomist, horticulturist, farm manager, extension officer	MSc, MBA Agri-business, PhD
Veterinary and animal sciences	Veterinarian, livestock officer, dairy and poultry specialist, researcher	MVSc, PhD
Forestry and environment	Forest officer (RFO / IFoS), wildlife biologist, environmental consultant	MSc Forestry, IFoS exam
Agri-industry	Seed, fertiliser, food-processing and agri-tech roles; NABARD and bank officers	MBA Agri-business
Entrepreneurship	Farmer, agri-start-up founder, organic and export farming	Training and incubation

8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Science PCB: biology research, biotechnology and NEET (see Science PCB document).
- Health and Allied: veterinary overlaps with biomedical research (see Health and Allied document).
- Skills and Entrepreneurship: agri-start-ups and skill training (see Skills and Entrepreneurship document).
- Civil services: IFoS and state agri / forest services (see Arts and Humanities document).

ONE-PAGE GIST: Agriculture, Veterinary and Forestry

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-10	Eco-club, garden, nature camps; keep Science strong
After Class 10	Choose PCB or PCMB; PUC in Karnataka
Class 11-12	Boards + KCET, CUET-UG (ICAR), NEET-UG (veterinary)
After Class 12	BSc Agri / Horticulture / Forestry, BFSc, BVSc & AH
Postgraduate	MSc Agri, MVSc, MBA Agri-business, ICAR-JRF, PhD
Career	Agri-officer, scientist, vet, forest officer (RFO / IFoS), agri-entrepreneur

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
KCET (Karnataka)	April (2026: 23-24)	PCMB; state quota 85% via KEA	No negative
CUET-UG (ICAR)	May-June†	50 MCQs per subject, 60 min; 15% all-India quota	+5 / -1
NEET-UG (BVSc)	May (2026 re-exam: 21 Jun)	180 Q, 720 marks; VCI merit rank	+4 / -1
IFoS (UPSC)	Yearly	Prelims + Mains + Interview; degree in listed subjects	Check notification

Key rules: BVSc needs NEET and 50% PCB; Karnataka agri seats use KCET (PCMB); ICAR gives 15% all-India quota via CUET.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8), CSSS (UG), ICAR / university scholarships.†

Careers: agri-officer, scientist, veterinarian, forest officer, agri-entrepreneur.

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LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Polytechnic Diploma and ITI (Technical Careers after Class 8 or 10): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Build hands-on skills, Maths and Science basics; try workshops, tinkering and craft	Technical aptitude
Class 8 entry	After Class 8	Some ITI trades accept Class 8 pass (Welder, Plumber, Carpenter, Mason and similar)	NCVT trade certificate, apprenticeship
Class 10 entry	After Class 10 (SSLC)	Polytechnic diploma (3 years) or ITI trade (6 months to 2 years)	Job-ready technical skills; lateral entry to engineering
Alternative	After Class 10	Continue to Class 11-12 for degrees	Compare time, cost and goal with a diploma
Diploma to degree	After diploma	Lateral entry into 2nd year BE / BTech through DCET (Karnataka)	Engineering degree in 3 more years
Job / apprenticeship	After ITI / diploma	Apprenticeship at PSUs, railways and industry; private and government technician jobs	Employment and certification
Career	-	Technician, junior engineer, supervisor, entrepreneur	See section 7

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-10: Foundation

- Decision: develop practical skills (electrical basics, tools, drawing, computing) alongside Maths and Science.
- Keep Maths and Science marks decent; polytechnic admission in Karnataka reportedly needs a Class 10 pass with Science and Maths†.

After Class 8

- ITI: Class 8 pass is enough for some trades (Welder, Plumber, Carpenter, Mason, Painter, Mechanic Agriculture Machinery).†

After Class 10 (SSLC)

- Polytechnic diploma: 3 years in Mechanical, Civil, Electrical (EEE), Electronics (ECE), Computer Science, Automobile and other branches; admission coordinated by the Directorate of Technical Education (DTE) Karnataka. One source says merit on SSLC marks; another says entrance-based; confirm the process.†
- ITI: Class 10 pass is needed for trades like Electrician, Fitter, Turner, Machinist, Draughtsman, COPA and Stenography. Duration 6 months to 2 years; over 130 trades nationally.

After diploma or ITI

- Diploma holders can enter engineering degrees in the second year (lateral entry) via Karnataka DCET. ITI holders may also join the second-year diploma at some polytechnics.†
- Apprenticeship: ITI is the standard route to apprenticeship at PSUs, Indian Railways and large manufacturers.†

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Career

- Technician, junior engineer, supervisor, CNC / machine operator, electrician, solar and EV technician, government technical posts; many start their own workshops.

3. Early preparation and school-level routes

Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
Tinkering labs, science exhibitions, workshops	Schools, NGOs, Atal Tinkering Labs†	6-12	Builds hands-on skill	Through the year
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb

Tip for parents: a diploma or ITI is a strong, early-earning path. Compare it with Class 11-12 plus engineering, and remember lateral entry keeps the engineering-degree option open.

4. Admission routes and exams

Diploma (Polytechnic) admission - Karnataka	
Conducting body	Directorate of Technical Education (DTE) Karnataka; dtetech.karnataka.gov.in
Eligibility	SSLC (Class 10) pass; one listing says Science and Maths with at least 35%†
Selection	Centralised counselling; reported as SSLC merit-based by one listing and entrance-based by another†
Duration	3 years (6 semesters); lateral entry for ITI holders to 2nd year at some polytechnics†

DCET (Diploma CET) - lateral entry to engineering	
Conducting body	Karnataka Examinations Authority (KEA); cetonline.karnataka.gov.in/kea
Used for	Direct entry to the 2nd year of BE / BTech for diploma holders (and BSc graduates in some cases)†
Frequency / dates	Once a year; 2026 reported as applications 17 March - 3 April, exam 23 May†
Pattern	Not confirmed†

ITI (Industrial Training Institute) admission	
Eligibility	By trade: Class 8 pass for some trades, Class 10 pass for others; age norms per NCVT†
Selection	Mostly merit on Class 10 / 8 marks through state counselling; a few states use an ITI CET. Karnataka 2026 notification not found†
Duration	6 months to 2 years; National Trade Certificate (NTC) after the All India Trade Test (AITT) by NCVT
Apprenticeship	Standard route for PSU, railway and industry apprenticeship†

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
Apprenticeship (Apprentices Act / NAPS)	ITI and diploma holders	Paid on-the-job training with industry; details not confirmed†
Karnataka Skill Development Corporation (KSDC) short courses	After Class 10 / 12	See Skills and Entrepreneurship document†
Direct polytechnic / ITI-to-degree bridge courses	Diploma and ITI holders	Lateral entry rules change; check each university†

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
GATE / university tests after BE	IIT-organised / universities	MTech after the degree	Feb†
Government technical posts (state PSC, SSC JE, RRB)	State / central	Junior Engineer and technician jobs	Per notification†

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
State scholarships for diploma and ITI students	Karnataka SSP and departments	Category and income based	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†

Note: CSSS applies to students scoring in the top 20 percentile of Class 12; it may not apply to ITI / diploma students entering after Class 10.†

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
Diploma in Mechanical / Civil / Electrical / Electronics / Computer Science / Automobile / Architecture / Mining etc.	3 yr	SSLC; DTE counselling	Technical diploma, lateral entry option
ITI trades (Electrician, Fitter, Welder, Turner, Machinist, COPA, Plumber, Carpenter etc.)	6 mo - 2 yr	Class 8 or 10 by trade	NCVT / NTC certificate
D.Pharm (after Class 12)	2 yr	PCB / PCM†	See Health and Allied document
BE / BTech (lateral entry)	3 yr	DCET	Engineering degree after diploma

Examples of institutions: Government Polytechnics across Karnataka (for example in Bengaluru, Mangaluru, Davangere), CITD / Government Tool Room and Training Centre (GTTC)†, Government and private ITIs, KSDC training centres.†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Technician and supervisor	Electrician, machinist, fitter, welder, CNC operator, maintenance technician	Skill upgrades, apprenticeship, NSQF levels
Junior engineer	Junior Engineer in PSUs, state departments, railways, private industry	BE via lateral entry, GATE
Skilled trades and construction	Plumber, carpenter, mason, solar and EV installer	Contractor licence, entrepreneurship
Entrepreneurship	Workshop owner, service centre, fabrication unit	MSME and skill loans

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8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Skills and Entrepreneurship: short-term courses, PMKVY and start-up support (see Skills and Entrepreneurship document).
- Science PCM: engineering degree via Class 11-12 or lateral entry (see Science PCM document).
- Defence: Agniveer Tradesman and technical entries (see Defence document).
- Health and Allied: D.Pharm and paramedical diplomas (see Health and Allied document).
- Agriculture: agricultural diploma and machinery trades (see Agriculture document).

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ONE-PAGE GIST: Polytechnic and ITI

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-10	Hands-on skills, Maths and Science basics; tinkering and workshops
After Class 8	ITI trades that accept Class 8 pass (Welder, Plumber, Carpenter, Mason)
After Class 10	Polytechnic diploma (3 yr) or ITI (6 mo - 2 yr)
Diploma to degree	Lateral entry to BE 2nd year via DCET
After ITI	NTC certificate; apprenticeship at PSUs, railways, industry
Career	Technician, junior engineer, supervisor, entrepreneur

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
Diploma (DTE Karnataka)	After SSLC results	3-year diploma; counselling	Check notification
DCET	Yearly (2026: 23 May)†	Lateral entry to BE 2nd year	Check notification
ITI admission	After Class 8 / 10	By trade; NCVT / NTC	Merit-based
AITT	End of ITI course	All India Trade Test by NCVT	Check NCVT

Key rules: ITI trades accept Class 8 or Class 10 by trade; diploma needs SSLC; lateral entry keeps the degree option open.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8), state scholarships via SSP.†

Careers: technician, junior engineer, machinist, electrician, supervisor, workshop owner.

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LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Skills and Entrepreneurship (Skill Courses, Start-ups, Self-employment): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Build curiosity, money sense, communication and teamwork; try simple projects	Entrepreneurial and practical habits
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Try small projects, school fairs and digital skills; learn basic budgeting	Skill courses and start-up ideas
Stream choice	After Class 10	Any stream; combine school with a skill or vocational course	Skill certificates alongside Class 11-12
Skill training	After Class 10 / 12	Short-term skill courses (PMKVY / NSQF-aligned), ITI, vocational diplomas	Job-ready certificate
Start-up path	Class 11+	Idea, prototype, small sales, mentoring, incubator support	First venture or freelance work
Growth	Years later	Scale, funding, partnerships, formal degrees if needed	Business or professional career

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-10: Foundation

- Decision: learn to save, budget and sell something small (school fair, craft, tutoring). Learn teamwork, communication and a digital skill (typing, spreadsheets, design, coding basics).
- School entrepreneurship or tinkering programmes (for example Atal Tinkering Labs and Startup India initiatives) may be available in some schools.†

After Class 10

- Combine Class 11-12 with a skill course in the evenings or holidays: digital marketing, coding, graphic design, accounting software, electrician or solar basics.
- Or move into ITI / vocational training (see Polytechnic and ITI document).

After Class 12

- Short-term certified training (PMKVY and NSQF-aligned courses), sector skill councils, vocational diplomas, apprenticeships.†
- Alongside a degree: internships, freelancing, small online or offline ventures.

Start-up and self-employment

- Steps: identify a problem, test with customers, build a minimum product, register the business, seek mentoring, loans or incubators.†
- Karnataka has a strong start-up ecosystem in Bengaluru; incubators and college entrepreneurship cells exist.†

3. Early preparation and school-level routes

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Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
School fairs, business-plan and innovation competitions	Schools, NGOs, banks	6-12	Teaches sales, budgeting and teamwork	Through the year
INSPIRE-MANAK	DST with NIF	6-12	School nominates up to 5 ideas; award 10,000 one-time	Check inspireawards-dst.gov.in†
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb

Tip for parents: encourage small, safe projects with real customers (family and neighbours) and teach the basics of money. Check that any paid skill course is NSQF-aligned and the provider is approved.

4. Schemes and routes

PMKVY 4.0 (Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana) - Skill India	
Who	Indian youth including school and college dropouts and unemployed; age reported as 15-59 by third-party sources (15-45 in a NIELIT notice for its own courses)†
What	Short-term training aligned to NSQF with a certificate; some sources mention a completion bonus (about 8,000) not verified†
Status	One source says the scheme was extended to 31 December 2026; another says no fixed end date. Conflicting†
Rules	Attendance of at least 50% reported for NIELIT-run courses; biometric attendance†
Where	pmkvyofficial.in and the Skill India Digital portal†

ITI and apprenticeship	
Details	See the Polytechnic and ITI document: ITI trades, NCVT certificate and apprenticeship route†

Entrepreneurship support (national and Karnataka)	
Startup India / MUDRA / state schemes	Not confirmed at the time of compilation†
NIESBUD and entrepreneurship development programmes	Not confirmed at the time of compilation†
Karnataka Skill Development Corporation (KSDC)	Not confirmed at the time of compilation†

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
Sector Skill Councils (IT-ITeS, Retail, Healthcare, Automotive, Construction and others)	Industry-led certification	NSQF-aligned certificates; list and fees vary†
Online skill platforms (NPTEL, SWAYAM, Skill India Digital)	Free or low-cost certificates	Check recognition and employer acceptance†
College entrepreneurship cells and incubators	Degree students with business ideas	Mentoring, small grants and workshops†
Freelancing and online work (design, coding, content, tutoring)	Teens and young adults	Portfolio-based; no entrance exam

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Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
MBA / PGDM entrepreneurship and family-business tracks	IIMs and others	Management and venture roles	CAT / university tests†
CA / CS / CMA and professional accounting (for founders)	ICAI / ICSI / ICMAI	Finance and compliance	See Commerce document†

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
Skill and entrepreneurship grants and loans (MUDRA, state schemes, incubator seed funds)	Government, banks, incubators	Applicants with business ideas	Varies	Per scheme†
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†

Note: always check scheme eligibility, interest and terms before borrowing for training or a business.†

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
PMKVY / NSQF short-term courses	Weeks to months	Open enrolment†	Certificate on completion
ITI trades	6 mo - 2 yr	Class 8 / 10	See Polytechnic and ITI document
Vocational courses in school (NSQF subjects) and diplomas	Class 9-12 / 1-3 yr	Schools and polytechnics†	Skills alongside academics
Digital skills (coding, marketing, design, data)	Weeks to months	Open enrolment	Portfolio and freelance work
Entrepreneurship programmes and incubation	Months	Application or pitch	Mentoring and networks

Examples of institutions and platforms: ITIs and polytechnics, NSDC training partners, NIELIT centres, Skill India Digital portal, NPTEL / SWAYAM, college incubators and the Bengaluru start-up ecosystem.†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Skilled trades and technicians	Electrician, solar installer, machine operator, mobile and appliance technician	Apprenticeship, advanced certificates
Digital and creative skills	Freelance designer, developer, marketer, video editor, data entry and analyst	Degree, certifications
Entrepreneur	Small-business owner, shop, workshop or service-company founder, start-up founder	Incubation, funding, MBA

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Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Self-employment in services	Tutor, caterer, salon, repair services, agri-business	Skill and enterprise loans

8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Polytechnic and ITI: formal technical routes (see Polytechnic and ITI document).
- Commerce: accounting, finance and business basics help every founder (see Commerce document).
- Design and Hospitality: design studios, cafes, events and travel ventures (see Design and Hospitality documents).
- Agriculture: agri-start-ups and farming (see Agriculture document).
- Sports and Arts: academies, coaching and creative businesses (see Sports and Arts document).

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ONE-PAGE GIST: Skills and Entrepreneurship

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-10	Small projects, budgeting, digital skill, teamwork
After Class 10	Any stream + a skill course; or ITI / vocational training
After Class 12	PMKVY / NSQF short courses, apprenticeship, internships, freelancing
Start-up	Idea, test, small sales, mentor, incubator, registration
Growth	Funding, scale, degree or professional course as needed
Career	Technician, freelancer, entrepreneur, self-employed professional

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
PMKVY 4.0	Rolling batches†	Short-term NSQF-aligned training; age 15-59 reported	Certificate
ITI	After Class 8 / 10	NCVT trades; see Polytechnic and ITI document	Trade test (AITT)
INSPIRE-MANAK	Yearly nominations	Ideas Class 6-12; 10,000 award	Selection
Incubators / programmes	Application-based	Mentoring, grants, networks†	Pitch / selection

Key rules: skills pay best when certified and combined with real projects; check provider approval and scheme terms.†

Scholarships and support: NMMS (Class 8), CSSS (UG), skill and business loans.†

Careers: technician, freelancer, shop or workshop owner, start-up founder, self-employed professional.

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LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Sports, Physical Education and Performing / Visual Arts: Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Try many sports, arts, music, dance and drama; find what you love	Early talent identification
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Train regularly; compete at school, district and state level; keep academics steady	Khelo India Athlete Scholarship (Class 9-12), KIYG / KIRTI trials
Stream choice	After Class 10	Any stream; Arts or Commerce is common for artists and athletes, Science for sports science	Time for training and practice
Preparation	Class 11-12	Sports: competitions and fitness; Arts: portfolio, auditions, grade exams	Sports quotas, BPEd / BFA / music admissions
Degree	After Class 12	BPEd, BSc Sports Science, BFA, BA Music / Dance / Theatre	Coaching, teaching, performance, creative careers
Professional	After training	Athlete, coach, referee, fitness trainer, artist, performer, teacher	Contracts, sponsorships, academies, services quotas
Postgraduate	3-5 years later	MPEd, MFA, MA Music / Dance, sports management / science	Senior coach, professor, curator, sports administrator

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-10: Foundation

- Decision: try many activities, then focus. Join school teams, district and state meets; for arts, join music, dance, drama and drawing classes with grade exams.
- Keep academics steady: boards and degree admission still matter even for athletes and artists.
- Sports talent schemes: Khelo India (KIRTI for under-14 to under-17; KIYG for under-17 and under-21) identifies athletes through tournaments and fitness trials.†

After Class 10

- Any stream works. Choose a stream that leaves time for training and practice; Humanities and Commerce are common, Science helps for sports science and physiotherapy.
- Sports: Khelo India Athlete Scholarship is listed for Class 9-12, UG and PG athletes who are scouted or selected; there is no direct application (register on the NSRS portal).†

Class 11-12: Preparation

- Sports: build a competition record (district, state, national); get fitness testing; update NSRS registration. Many universities and services give sports quotas.
- Arts: build a portfolio, audition reels and grade-exam certificates; check university and institute selection rules.

After Class 12: Degree

- Physical Education: BPEd at institutions like LNIPE Gwalior; BSc / BA Sports Science; coaching diplomas (NIS Patiala and others†).

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- Arts: BFA, Bachelor of Visual Arts (BVA), BA / BPA in Music, Dance, Theatre; Karnataka options include Karnataka Chitrakala Parishath, Bangalore University and Kannada University Hampi.†

Career

- Athlete, coach, trainer, referee, sports scientist, physiotherapist, sports manager; teacher of physical education; artist, musician, dancer, actor, art teacher, curator, animator, designer.

3. Early routes and talent schemes

Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
School, district and state competitions	Schools, sports departments, SGFI†	6-12	Foundation for selection and quotas	Through the year
Khelo India: KIRTI (U14-U17) and KIYG (U17, U21)	Sports Authority of India / Khelo India	9-12 and above	Talent hunt and annual multi-sport games; trials feed scholarships	Annual†
Music, dance and art grade exams	Boards and institutes†	6-12	Certificates for admissions	Through the year
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb

Tip for parents: sports and arts careers need early practice and a backup plan. Keep Class 12 marks reasonable, track competition records, and check quotas before choosing a course.

4. Scholarships, entrance routes and quotas

Khelo India Athlete Scholarship	
Provider	Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports / Sports Authority of India (kheloindia.gov.in)
Amount (reported)	About 6.28 lakh per year: 1.2 lakh out-of-pocket allowance + 5.08 lakh for training and academy costs†
Eligibility	Listed for Class 9-12, UG and PG athletes; no direct application; athletes are scouted through KIYG, KIRTI and trials, registered on the NSRS portal†
Duration	Up to 8 years, subject to annual performance audits†
Deadline	One third-party source lists 31 Dec 2026; treat with caution because selection is talent-based†

BPEd and sports education (LNIPE Gwalior and others)	
Conducting body	Lakshmibai National Institute of Physical Education (LNIPE), Gwalior; lnipe.edu.in
Entry	Official 2026-27 notice ties admission to CUET-UG registration plus a Physical Fitness Test and Sports Skill Proficiency Test in late June 2026; another listing mentions an LNIPE entrance test. Last application date was 18 June 2026†
Eligibility	10+2 with at least 50% (General / OBC), lower for SC/ST and some sports achievers; sports merit quota for medallists†

Sports quotas in admissions and jobs	
Admissions	Many universities, professional colleges and state CET seats keep sports quotas for state, national and international players†
Jobs and services	Sports quotas exist in railways, banks, police and armed forces; rules vary by employer†

Performing and visual arts admission (Karnataka)

Karnataka Chitrakala Parishath (BVA / BFA)	Reported eligibility 10+2 with 50%; accepted entrance tests listed as PGCET, NID entrance, AIEED, CUET and an internal exam; sources dated 2023 and conflicting†
BFA colleges in general	Many admit on Class 12 marks; some need a portfolio or aptitude test†
BPA (music, dance, theatre)	Karnataka universities (Bangalore University, Mysore University, Kannada University Hampi) run programmes; eligibility and dates not found†

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
Sports science, sports management, physiotherapy	Support careers	See Health and Allied document for physiotherapy†
Coaching certification (NIS and federation courses)	Aspiring coaches	Details not confirmed at the time of compilation†
Private academies (cricket, football, badminton, athletics, swimming, tennis)	Athletes aged 8+	Fees and selection vary; check track record†
Music, dance, theatre and fine-arts institutes and gurukulams	Artists	Grade exams and performance-based progress†

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
MPEd and sports science PG	LNIPE and universities	Teaching and coaching careers	Per admission cycle†
MFA / MA Music, Dance, Theatre	Universities	Teaching, performance, research	Entrance tests vary†
UGC-NET (Physical Education, Music, Fine Arts)	NTA	Lectureship and research	Twice a year†

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
Khelo India Athlete Scholarship	Sports Authority of India	Selected athletes (Class 9-12, UG, PG)	About 6.28 lakh per year (reported)	Talent-based†
State sports and cultural scholarships (Karnataka)	State sports and culture departments	Medallists and talented artists	Varies	Per scheme†
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†

Note: INSPIRE-SHE is for natural and basic sciences and does not apply here.†

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
BPEd (Bachelor of Physical Education)	2-4 yr	LNIPE and university tests	School PE teacher, coach

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
BSc / BA Sports Science and sports management	3-4 yr	CUET / university	Analysis, performance, administration
BFA / BVA / BA Fine Arts	3-4 yr	Merit, portfolio or test	Painting, sculpture, applied art
BA / BPA in Music, Dance, Theatre	3 yr	Auditions or merit	Performance and teaching
Coaching diplomas	1 yr	Federation / NIS selection†	Certified coach

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): Lakshmibai National Institute of Physical Education (Gwalior), Sports Authority of India centres, Karnataka Chitrakala Parishath, Bangalore University, Kannada University Hampi, NID and Srishti for design-linked arts.†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Competitive sport	Athlete, team player, trainer, sponsored player, sports-quota government job	Coaching, management, sports science
Coaching and teaching	Coach, PE teacher, fitness and strength trainer, referee, umpire	BPEd, MPEd, coaching diplomas
Sports business and science	Sports manager, sports scientist, physiotherapist, analyst	Sports management, physiotherapy
Performing arts	Musician, dancer, actor, theatre artist, teacher, composer	MA / MFA, teaching, UGC-NET
Visual arts	Painter, sculptor, illustrator, curator, art teacher, animator, designer	MFA, design courses

8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Health and Allied: physiotherapy and sports medicine (see Health and Allied document).
- Design and Architecture: B.Des, animation and visual communication (see Design and Architecture document).
- Defence: sportspersons may use sports quotas in the services (see Defence document).†
- Arts and Humanities: BA with music, dance and fine arts subjects (see Arts and Humanities document).
- Skills and Entrepreneurship: academies, studios and coaching businesses (see Skills and Entrepreneurship document).

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ONE-PAGE GIST: Sports and Performing and Visual Arts

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-10	Try sports and arts; train; school / district / state meets; grade exams
After Class 10	Any stream; keep academics steady; Khelo India for Class 9-12 athletes
Class 11-12	Competition record, portfolio, auditions; sports quota awareness
After Class 12	BPEd, Sports Science, BFA / BVA, BA Music / Dance / Theatre
Postgraduate	MPEd, MFA, MA, UGC-NET
Career	Athlete, coach, PE teacher, artist, performer, curator, sports manager

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
Khelo India (KIRTI / KIYG)	Annual†	Talent hunt and youth games; trials; NSRS registration	Selection-based
LNIPE BPEd	Apply by mid-June (2026: 18 Jun)	CUET-UG registration + physical tests (official 2026-27 notice)	Check prospectus
Karnataka Chitrakala Parishath BVA	Yearly†	10+2 with 50%; tests conflicting	Check college
Sports quota admissions	With admission cycle	Records at state / national / international level	Check KEA and universities

Key rules: sports and arts need early practice, records and certificates; keep academics steady; check quotas before choosing a course.†

Scholarships: Khelo India (about 6.28 lakh per year, selection-based), NMMS (Class 8), CSSS (UG).†

Careers: athlete, coach, PE teacher, sports scientist, musician, dancer, painter, curator.

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